

FINAL REPORT

Ninth General Service Conference

of

Alcoholics Anonymous

Hotel Commodore, New York City

April 22 - 26, 1959



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1959 FINAL REPORT

General Service Conference of A. A.

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1959 Conference At A Glance

TRUSTEE RATIO

In deference to traditional Conference balloting procedures on policy matters, the Delegates agreed, prior to the vote, that 55 affirmative votes (two-thirds of the Area Delegates) would be required for adoption of the proposal. The present ratio is eight non-members to seven members.

The proposal to recommend a change in the current ratio of Trustees to nine alcoholics and nine A.A. members failed of passage; 46 affirmative votes were cast, 36 negative.

* * *

FINANCES

Reaffirmed the principle that local Areas, groups and members are the ultimate authority for determining the approaches, techniques and methods for developing support of A.A.'s world services, recognizing that many groups ask the General Service Office to suggest a "yardstick" for contributions. The Delegates approved references in G.S.O. correspondence to the fact that some A.A. groups now contribute on the basis of \$3.00 per year per member.

Expressed interest in an experimental plan permitting individual members (who are no longer active in group affairs) to contribute directly to support of world services, and suggested that the plan continue to be explored.

* * *

LITERATURE

Recommended that the new folder, "Inside A.A.," be utilized in informing the membership on "how things get done in A.A. on a worldwide basis."

Approved preliminary plans for the preparation of a pamphlet designed to be helpful to inmate alcoholics, to A.A. institutional committees and to members and others who seek to assist alcoholics in prisons.

Approved preliminary plans for the preparation of a pamphlet to inform interested clergymen of A.A.'s sole purpose "and how they may be able to help the alcoholic to find sobriety in A.A."

Approved up-dating of the pamphlet on "The Alcoholic Employee," following a survey on references to the A.A. program in the programs of business and industrial firms.

Approved the preparation of material for new Loners, utilizing information derived from a recently-completed Loner questionnaire.

* * *

BEQUESTS

Reaffirmed the Traditional A.A. principle that A.A. should not accept financial bequests in any form, from members or non-members.

A. A. TODAY

(Based on reports to G.S.O.)

Groups in U. S.	5,443
Members in U. S.	98,858
Groups in Canada	775
Members in Canada	11,181
Groups Overseas	915
Members Overseas	14,306
Internationalists	165
Hospital Groups	285
Members in Hospitals ...	7,077
Prison Groups	347
Members in Prisons ...	14,243

Totals Reported
7,765 Groups
145,830 Members

RELATIONS WITH OTHERS

Adopted a resolution:

(1) Expressing appreciation of the "spirit and assistance" manifested by various agencies in the field of alcoholism,

(2) Emphasizing willingness to cooperate "short of affiliation . . . in any way,"

(3) Restating the importance of the Seventh Tradition on self-support;

(4) Pointing out that it is deemed entirely proper that some members, "acting solely as citizens, may take positions with these agencies or commissions, but in no way acting or speaking as representatives of Alcoholics Anonymous."

Recommended that specific material be prepared to fill the need apparent in a number of Areas for material clarifying the A.A. Tradition ("Cooperation, Yes—Affiliation, No") on the relationship of the society and its members to outside agencies.

* * *

1960 CONVENTION

Demonstrated widespread movement interest in supporting the 25th Anniversary Convention of A.A. at Long Beach, California, July 1-3, 1960. Many Areas reported that planes, trains and buses are being chartered to take members to Long Beach.

AREA DELEGATES ONLY

As in past years, an entire evening session of the 1959 Conference was set aside as an "Area Delegates Only" meeting. Trustees, G.S.O. people and those affiliated with The A.A. Grapevine were excluded.

Chairman of the "A.D.O." meeting was Willard M. of Manitoba. The meeting elected Jim G. of Chicago to serve as Chairman at the 1960 Conference.

GRAPEVINE

Recommended inauguration of a plan at the State and Area level whereby a permanent Area Grapevine Representative be appointed to work independently of the General Service Representative, "stressing the Grapevine as a vital tool of communication within A.A."

Recommended that State and Area conferences be encouraged to have a local Grapevine representative in attendance to "encourage" subscriptions.

* * *

DIRECTORY

In regard to misuse of the World Directory by A.A. members, urged that the attention of the groups again be directed to the purpose of the Directory, as stated on the inside cover of the book, but cautioned against interfering with free communication among A.A.s.

In regard to misuse of the Directory by non-members, recommended that procedures previously used be followed (These have generally consisted of a letter to the person or agency misusing the Directory, pointing out that the book is confidential and for A.A. use only.)

* * *

GENERAL SERVICES

Approved, after careful deliberation, the caliber and scope of activities performed, and decisions made, by the General Service Office and the Trustees of the General Service Board as part of A.A.'s world service.

* * *

TERMS OF DELEGATES

Refused to consider, by an overwhelming margin, a suggestion that in the future the term of office of Conference Delegates be extended from two years to three years. The Delegates voted unanimously to continue the two-year term of office.

* * *

BULLETIN

Approved the new format and editorial approach of The A.A. Exchange Bulletin and recommended that the new plan be continued for the next year.

* * *

LISTING OF MEETINGS

Approved a suggestion that meeting nights be listed in the World Directory when groups make this information available.

* * *

Formal advisory actions of the 1959 Conference begin on page 28.

THE SENSE OF THE CONFERENCE

Confidence, Absence of Fear of Future, Were Main Themes

The Ninth General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous, which met for four days at the Hotel Commodore in New York City late in April, 1959, was regarded by some observers as a "quiet" Conference. Certainly it lacked the flamboyance of some earlier gatherings, the marked caution of others, the evidence of confusion apparent occasionally in the past.

The Delegates who served the movement at the 1959 Conference were, in the main, well informed on the Third Legacy structure of A.A.'s world services. Many of them had served long apprenticeships of service to fellow alcoholics at Group, District and Area levels. They were familiar with the myriad problems that, multiplied manifold, confront the General Service Office in its world-wide service efforts in behalf of members, groups and interested "outsiders." If the Delegates were not awed by these problems, it was because they appeared overwhelmingly confident that patient effort and adherence to A.A. Tradition were keys to the solution of any crisis which might arise in the future.

Endorse Service Structure

This sense of confidence, of absence of fear, was perhaps the dominant theme. It was the distinguishing mark of experienced A.A.s who endorsed the movement's expanding service structure out of the conviction that it was the only practical, the only truly *simple*, way of assuring the survival of the Society for themselves and for the "millions who still don't know."

If the meeting was quiet and placid, it was not because the Delegates did not consider issues that were, at least potentially, explosive or subtly divisive.

Devotion To Tradition

The calm, principled manner in which the 1959 Conference reached a decision *not* to recommend a change in the Trustee ratio reflected reasoned as well as heartfelt devotion to the Tradition that, in the absence of near unanimity, A.A. should hesitate to venture into uncharted waters. Future Conferences, reflecting the collective wisdom of future generations of A.A.s may reach a different decision. Meanwhile, the 1959 Conference must be recorded as a body of A.A. servants whose confidence in the future of the movement enabled them to make a "difficult" decision with dignity and grace.

In a small way, the decision not to recommend extension of the Delegates' term from two to three years was significant also. In a less mature gathering, this suggestion alone could have proved highly divisive. Yet so strong was this Conference's respect for the principle of rotation of office in A.A. that the Delegates voted unanimously to retain the present two-year term of office.

From a policy viewpoint, few decisions in recent years have been more far-reaching than the agreement by the 1959 Conference that the General Service Office should remind the Areas that some groups are now contributing \$3 per year per member in support of world services, rather than \$2., as in the past. This realistic approach to the delicate subject of financial support revealed substantial confidence that many established groups now recognize the scope of service provided by G.S.O.—and

the importance of strengthening this service. The action of the Conference may have been taken quietly and without verbal fireworks; it remained confident action, taken by confident men and women.

Remarks By Bill W.

In his stirring closing remarks Sunday afternoon, Co-Founder Bill W. recalled how the Conference had laughed when a Delegate reported that a convention treasurer in his state had absconded with convention funds.

"There was a time when any such announcement in A.A. would have been shattering," Bill said. "I remembered all our fears of the early times—fears for sobriety, for the existence of a group, for the survival of the movement. But in that laugh about an absconding treasurer, I found a mighty assurance for our future. In that laugh could be found no trace of a desire for punishment of the erring brother. In that laugh, I found complete understanding. In that laugh, I found recognition by each of us that, as individuals, we are still capable of any folly. And in this laugh I found a complete absence of fear of what any individual within or without A.A. could possibly do to us."

"We are surrounded," Bill pointed out, "by a world in which fear is the keynote, in which fear is taking a destructive course, in which fear drives men to bigotry, to murderous war and to an unending category of other griefs. Another characteristic we see in the world around us is that, generally speaking, all societies and nations are apt to behave, as a whole, far worse than the majority of their individual members."

Reverse Condition In A.A.

In A.A. we have exactly the reverse condition, Bill suggested. "As a society we have made no aggressions on the world outside and the world has not trespassed upon us; it has befriended us. We have exhibited no bigotry, very little intolerance. As a society of still very frail individuals, our collective behavior has been far better than our behavior as individuals, to whom anything can happen.

"I found behind that laugh in this Conference a sense of tremendous collective security, an absence of fear of members who may be ill. Thus we have capitalized upon fear while the world in general seems to be deteriorating under fear."

As he has done so many times in the past, Bill, with his unique insight, has stated the underlying significance of a Conference with distinctive clarity.

It is becoming increasingly clear to many observers not only that A.A. Conferences have special "personalities" of their own but that each succeeding Conference draws a part of its strength from the accumulated experience of earlier meetings. The real measure of a Conference is no longer whether it is timid or aggressive, quiet or extremely active. The real test is whether a Conference is informed on the Society's service needs and whether it can reach decisions—small or momentous—solely in term's of A.A.'s primary purpose.

Viewed in this perspective, the "quiet" Conference of 1959 was perhaps the most notable in the nine years of G.S.C. activities.

TRUST OF 'SERVANTS' NECESSARY, BILL SAYS

(Excerpts from Talk at Opening Dinner)

The Society of Alcoholics Anonymous cannot operate except in an atmosphere of trust of its "servants" at all levels of the movement, Bill W., co-founder, reminded the Delegates to the Ninth General Service Conference at their opening dinner session.

"Trust has a pretty close kinship with love and it is of the essence of love," Bill declared. "This society cannot operate without some kind of trust. Nor can we operate as individuals without some kind of trust. I think of the degree of trust that we have in God, in our principles and in each other as something for wonder."

"We trust because we must," Bill suggested. "And having done that, we trust because it is right. And, finally, we trust because we want to."

Bill noted that the word "trust" appears once in the Twelve Traditions. "We think of Tradition Two as having to do with the group conscience, our sole authority as God may speak through it. Too often, perhaps, we overlook that other reference which describes our leaders as 'trusted servants.'"

'Process of Delegation'

"The sponsor talking with the new person on a basis of trust, the group that must trust the people it names to serve them, the GSRs, the Delegates, the Trustees and the Service Office people—all of them really have to operate, and do operate, on a basis of trust."

The co-founder of A. A., in a brief synopsis of the movement's history, recalled that a "process of delegation" based on trust had been responsible for the creation and development of A. A.'s movement-wide service facilities.

"The groups turned over the care of the Fellowship's public relations to the Trustees of the General Service Board (then The Alcoholic Foundation). The monthly magazine, *The A. A. Grapevine*, was made a part of the headquarters operation. The Service Office, the publications, group relations, foreign relations, preparation of literature—all of the multitude of tasks you see being performed here now—were actually delegated from the founders to a Board of Trustees which was authorized to conduct A. A.'s world service affairs. These were successive acts of delegation, successive acts of trust based on Dr. Bob's trust and my trust and yours in the Trustees—and their trust and love of us."

Concern Over Linkage

Bill reminded his hearers of the days when Dr. Bob, the Akron surgeon who co-founded A. A., had become ill and fears had arisen concerning the linkage between the groups and the Board of Trustees. "After all, the Board was very anonymous, and more and more isolated as the movement grew larger and larger." Bill and Dr. Bob and "a couple of gals in the service office" were the only widely known links, he said.

This concern over the future relationship of the movement to its Trustees led to the long debate over whether to convene a Conference. The Traditions, meanwhile, had been reduced to writing. It was recognized that the authority for service came from the groups themselves. "They named their servants. The responsibility for service belonged to the groups."

In the matter of world service, however, another relationship prevailed at the time, Bill pointed out. "A group of elders"

was providing the leadership and there was need for linkage to be forged between the Trustees and the movement." The problem, he said, was: "How could a body of advisors to the Board of Trustees be created to take the place of Dr. Bob and me and the other old-timers?"

Failure to create linkage of this type presented the risk of "collapse in the middle of the movement," Bill said. "One big blunder and confidence would be lost, and it would be very difficult to restore."

Bill recalled that there had been some "very good" objections to the idea of establishing a Conference. These, he said, had been based largely on the fear of "politicking" and on a desire to "keep things simple."

Five-Year Experiment

It was finally realized that "collapse would not mean simplicity, it would mean confusion. The awful risk was that the whole structure which had accounted for spreading A. A. across the world, which had accounted for much of our growth and unity might just simply collapse—or might dry up gradually as less and less became known of the Trustees."

"We also realized," Bill declared, "that this Society was entitled to come in here and take a look at the people operating its services, to look at the assets that were in trust for them." The Conference was set up originally on a five-year experimental basis, Bill said, "because we finally saw that it would be better than no Conference at all." Even had it failed, a method of assembling it would have been created, he noted.

Bill said he was "supremely confident that this magnificent structure can endure and rise above any future trials or perils that may be thrust upon it. We will build this service and maintain it because we must, because we ought to and, as we know more about it, because we shall dearly want to."

"There are students of these matters who have at times predicted to me that our present structure of service cannot endure; that, when the old-timers are gone and the strains of living in this perilous world are thrust upon us in full force, we shall not be able to 'take it.' They say that one of the reasons we shall not be able to do this is because we are flying in the face of much of human experience and all of present-day trends."

'We Require No Government'

"The present-day trends are toward centralized and personalized leadership. These trends center around greater and greater power in the few. The needs of the times, people say, require it."

"A. A. says No! For your purposes, yes; but for our purposes, No! We do not require concentrated power any place. We do not require a government. We do not require any government agency. Barleycorn will kill us if we don't behave, as individuals and as groups. Barleycorn is our dictator and he is enough, provided that we have rightly structured our functional and service efforts."

"As my own term of service with respect to world affairs is drawing to an end, I would like to be sure that we have availed ourselves of every structural device and developed every aspect of our experience to perfect our structure of service to make sure that it will endure in a spirit of faith, based on trust."

TRUSTEE RATIO

A carefully-considered policy decision was recorded at the second session of the 1959 Conference. The proposal to change the ratio on the General Service Board to nine alcoholic Trustees and nine non-alcoholic Trustees failed of acceptance. The ratio thus continues to be eight non-alcoholics and seven A.A.s.

Voting on the proposal itself was preceded by passage of four prior motions designed to reaffirm balloting procedures on which all Area Delegates were clearly in agreement. (Trustees and other non-Area members of the Conference had earlier agreed not to participate in the voting.)

First, the Delegates passed, with virtual unanimity a motion to *proceed to vote* on the proposal. Second, in consideration of procedures suggested in the Third Legacy Manual, they agreed that an affirmative vote for the change in Trustee ratio would not be binding unless it was carried by a *two-thirds majority*. Third, they agreed to vote by *secret, written ballot*. Fourth, they empowered the chairman to cast the *proxy vote* of a Delegate who had been forced to leave the Conference due to a death in his family.

With 55 votes required for adoption of the proposal, the motion to change the ratio of Trustees failed of passage when 46 affirmative votes were recorded; 36 negative.

Discussion of the role of non-alcoholic Trustees dates back to the first Conference in 1951 when the Delegates affirmed that such Trustees should continue to serve on the Board, then known as The Alcoholic Foundation. In 1955, the Conference tabled a proposal for changing the ratio. A year later, the Delegates approved continuance of the existing structure of the Board of Trustees until 1958, with further study recommended at the 1957 meeting.

The 1957 Delegates again tabled the question, recommending further consideration in 1958. In the latter year, the Conference approved in principle a proposal offered by Mr. Bernard B. Smith, former non-alcoholic Chairman of the Board who continues to serve as a Trustee. The Smith proposal, which called for changing the ratio to "nine and nine," was favored in principle by a 65-to-12 margin, subject to review in the Areas prior to the 1959 Conference.

This action was widely publicized in Conference reports and G.S.O. bulletins. The proposal was then presented formally to the groups in a memorandum last November. Between that time and the convening of the 1959 Conference, the proposed change was given detailed consideration throughout the Areas represented in the Conference.

RELATIONS WITH OUTSIDE AGENCIES

Early in the Conference it became apparent that a number of Delegates reflected the serious concern of their Areas over public misunderstanding of the role of A.A. in the programs of outside agencies such as State and Municipal Commissions, educational committees and similar units. Delegates from four Areas cited specific situations in which the A.A. name was being used inappropriately. In at least one case, the outside agency involved had used the A.A. name in newspaper advertising in support of fund raising. In other cases, it was indicated that directors of tax-supported agencies were overzealous in their desire to support A.A.

While most of the discussion was concerned with the risks involved when State or local A.A. units permit themselves to become identified with outside agencies, at least one speaker pointed out that the Fellowship should never fail to appreciate

the tribute paid to it by offers of support from others interested in helping alcoholics.

The Delegates approved formation of a special *Study Committee on Relations With Outside Agencies* to consider various aspects of the problem and report back to the full Conference prior to adjournment. An eleven-member group was formed under the chairmanship of Herb Morse, currently chairman of the General Service Board's Public Information Committee.

In its report, adopted unanimously by the Conference, the special Committee recommended adoption of the resolution shown in the Committee's report. The Committee also recommended preparation of concise informational material that could be used by Area Committees to clarify A.A.'s traditional policy of "Cooperation, yes—Affiliation, no" in its relations with outside agencies.

The full text of the Committee report, is shown on page 28.

LISTING MEETINGS IN DIRECTORIES

For a number of years many groups throughout the Fellowship have suggested that group meeting nights be identified in World Directory listings. This was not considered feasible during the period when the Directory was being published in the two-column format.

Subsequent studies have indicated that, with the one-column

type layouts being used currently, meeting nights can now be coded into listings without increasing the size of the Directory.

The Delegates approved a proposal to include these listings, with the understanding that this will be done only in cases where the information is volunteered by the groups. Several Delegates commented that this change should increase the value of the Directory substantially.

SUGGESTED PER CAPITA CONTRIBUTION

Delegates were asked to advise the General Service Office on the desirability of suggesting, in fund appeals to the groups, that \$3 per year per member be used as a "yardstick" in determining the size of voluntary contributions for support of A. A. world services.

For a number of years "\$2 per year per member" had been the suggested yardstick. The 1958 Fall appeal was the first to mention that many groups were contributing at the \$3. rate.

After a relatively brief discussion, Thursday afternoon the Conference voted unanimously to approve use of the \$3 figure in future Group Fund appeal letters. Key points made by various Delegates during this session included: (1) All costs are up these days but A. A. world services should not suffer as a consequence; (2) The Service Office should be operated on a pay-as-you-go plan; (3) Groups should be encouraged to budget for support of G. S. O.; (4) Individual members should be made more aware of worldwide Twelfth Step responsibilities. Only one Delegate spoke against the increase.

The suggested per capita increase was also endorsed by the Conference Policy Committee in its preliminary report Saturday morning. At that time one Delegate spoke against the increase,

apparently under the impression that it represented an attempt to "tax" the groups. The ensuing discussion was valuable in that it permitted clarification of the following points:

1. No "tax is intended or implied. Groups have asked for guidance on the subject of contributions and the \$3. per year per member figure is a realistic attempt to provide this guidance.
2. The former suggested contribution (\$2) had not been realistic since Group contributions had failed to underwrite G. S. O. operations in behalf of the groups in eight of the past ten years.
3. Bill pointed out that in the past, when G. S. O. had not been specific in suggesting a per capita contribution, Service Office deficits had been as high as \$30,000 in a single year.

Following this discussion the Delegate who had originally objected to use of the \$3 figure withdrew his objection, declaring that he was not opposed to the suggested per capita increase, provided it was clearly not a mandatory tax upon the groups.

PILOT PLAN FOR GROUP PLEDGES

The General Service Board, at its January, 1959, meeting, had recommended that tests be conducted in certain Areas to determine whether groups would be willing to make advance pledges of estimated contributions to General Service Office. If these pilot plans proved successful, the Board suggested, consideration would be given to the possibility of instituting a movement-wide pledge program.

The subject was discussed in general terms at the Thursday and Friday sessions of the Conference. Trustee Icky S. pointed out that the plan was designed to relieve Delegates of constant fund-raising responsibilities and to enable G. S. O. to get away from the necessity of "budgeting in the dark." Under the pre-

sent arrangement, he said, G. S. O. cannot determine until December 31st of any year how much money it actually could count on from the groups during the preceding twelve months. He said professional fund raisers had termed this system "ridiculous" and asked the Area Delegates to consider specific "pledge plan" ideas at the "Area Delegates Only" meeting.

Since the reports of the "Area Delegates Only" meeting, of the Finance Committee and of the Policy Committee contained no reference to the proposed pilot plan for group pledges, the status of this recommendation by the General Service Board remains unchanged.

1959 GENERAL SERVICE BUDGET

The following budget for 1959 operations of the General Service Office, exclusive of the A. A. Grapevine, was approved by the Conference:

ESTIMATED CONTRIBUTIONS, GROSS PROFIT, AND OPERATING EXPENSES

	Receipts	Expenses	Net Income	Net (Deficit)
General Service Office (Contributions)	205,000	202,800*	2,200	
A. A. Publishing, Inc. (Gross Profit)	186,100**	147,160	38,940	
General Service Board		18,100		(18,100)
TOTALS	391,100	368,060	41,140	(18,100)

NET ESTIMATED INCOME \$23,040***

* Including cost of General Service Conference..... 24,500

** Based Upon Sales of —

20,000 books "Alcoholics Anonymous"
7,000 books "12 Steps & 12 Traditions"
4,000 books "A. A. Comes of Age"
Averaged—Pamphlets & Miscellaneous

*** Exclusive of Reserve Fund Appreciation of..... 13,750 (from Book Discounts and Interest)

Despite rising costs and increased activity, the estimated expenses of G. S. O. have increased by only \$8,105 over the annual cost of such services during 1958.

Contributions of \$205,000 might be expected during 1959, representing about \$16,500 in excess of the total received in 1958. Each year over the past several years, contributions have increased annually as the need for G. S. O. Services becomes more widely known.

The suggested per capita "share of the budget," based on reported membership for the U. S. and Canada, is \$1.85 for the year 1959.

1959 A. A. GRAPEVINE BUDGET

The following budget for 1959 operations of the A. A. Grapevine, Inc., was accepted by the Conference:

Estimated income from subscriptions and bulk sales..... \$133,100
Total Expenses..... 138,801
Estimated Net Loss for the year 1959..... (5,701)

TERM OF DELEGATES

From time to time during recent years the suggestion has been made that Conference Delegates could be more effective in developing A. A.'s Third Legacy if they could serve three years rather than two. It has been argued that a Delegate spends his first year in office "learning the ropes" and reaches his peak of efficiency at about the time he is due to be rotated out of office.

The counter argument has been that the principle of rotation in service jobs has proved effective at all levels of A. A. and

should not be abrogated lightly. A corollary claim has been that it is desirable to create a large group of informed ex-Delegates as a practical means of developing increased awareness of A. A. world services in the Areas.

Delegates to the Ninth Conference were asked to review the subject. After brief discussion, dominated by the negative viewpoints outlined above, the Conference voted unanimously to retain the present two-year term of office for Delegates.

MISUSE OF DIRECTORY

The perennial problem of how to cope with misuse of the A. World Directory by commercial interests was discussed in a new light at the Ninth General Service Conference.

The discussion was highlighted by Co-Founder Bill W.'s reminder of the importance of preserving the "deep principle" of free communication among A. A.s, even though observance of this principle may lead indirectly to abuse of the Directory by "outsiders."

Bill's comments were prompted by a review of the problem that indicated an absence of agreement on "what constitutes use of the book for A. A. purposes." It could be argued, a G. S. O. staff member suggested, that use of the Directory to promote an A. A. banquet or a State Convention could be con-

strued as a commercial purpose. One Delegate noted that an A. A. member, with the approval of his group, was using the Directory to market a type of A. A. emblem.

There appeared to be general agreement that use of the Directory for personal profit, whether by a member or an outsider, could be considered "misuse" of the annual listing.

"Any one can obtain a copy of the Directory, if he really tries," Bill said. "Thus, in a practical sense, we can't be protected against the Directory getting into dubious hands. At the same time, where internal use is concerned, we should take care to preserve the deep principle of free communication among A. A.s. We can caution against misuse of the book by members but we ought to go slow on inhibiting free communication within the Society, even if this involves some risk."

PILOT PLAN FOR INDIVIDUAL CONTRIBUTIONS

The 1958 Conference had approved inauguration of a pilot plan designed to make it possible for "inactive" members to make direct, individual contributions to the support of A. A. world services.

In a preliminary report on results to date, Hank G., chairman of the General Service Committee, said that between \$5,000 and \$6,000 had been received in individual contributions during the last few months of 1958. Receipt of these funds followed limited distribution of a special letter to personal friends of several older members. Hank credited California A. A.s with special enthusiasm for the pilot plan.

The plan has created great interest, the chairman reported, and a second mailing is currently being prepared. Under the

plan, interested A. A.s suggest the names of potential contributors but actual mailing of all letters is handled by G. S. O. This procedure has been adopted so that a single master file of potential contributors can be kept up-to-date and so that no old timer will receive more than one letter inviting him to contribute. Nearly all of the initial contributors have asked for an annual reminder, Hank said.

The plan is designed to supplement, not replace, group contributions and should not be tied in with other Conference activities, it was pointed out.

After brief discussion favoring the plan, the Conference voted unanimously to recommend continuation of the pilot plan for individual contributions on an exploratory basis.

POLICY ON ACCEPTING ANNUITIES

A. A. traditionally does not accept bequests. Adherence to this policy has led the General Service Board to decline acceptance of thousands of dollars bequeathed to A. A. by members or friends of the movement.

The Ninth General Service Conference clarified this policy by specifically recommending that A. A. continue to decline "bequests in any form, from members or non-members." This action was taken when a Delegate requested guidance for this

Area on whether or not a \$100 annuity should be accepted from a trust fund a member plans to create.

Although a majority of the Delegates appeared to oppose accepting such a gift, several suggested that there was a difference between a large "lump sum" gift and a \$100 annuity. The problem was referred to the "Area Delegates Only" meeting, which recommended unanimously that the "Traditional A. A. principle" be affirmed.

GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE

(Eve M.)

This past year has been one in which understanding and interest in our Third Legacy of Service has come to include more and more A. A. groups and members.

With more Areas sending us information pertaining to Area meetings G. S. O. has been able to pass on to others many workable ideas.

In this "sharing of experience" the past year has been notable for:

1. Enlargement of committees, thus reducing the number of groups or size of any Area, so the Committeemen can do a better job.
2. Increase of Area meetings. Many are now held on a monthly basis, rotated from town to town within the Area.
3. Increased interest on the part of the General Service Representatives in their own responsibilities and in service as a whole.
4. Opening of Conference meetings to all interested A. A.s, rather than restricting them to General Service Representatives and Committeemen. This has developed increased knowledge and interest in the General Service Conference, and the relationship of each A. A. to it.

From all this has come an increased awareness on the part

of many A. A.s that this Conference—this voice of A. A.'s Group Conscience—is truly theirs.

The listing of subjects to be reviewed at the 1959 Conference documents this point. Four of these six subjects were submitted from Areas and Delegates—one from a General Service Representative.

This effort made by Delegates and their Committees to carry the message of service is undoubtedly responsible for the fact that we have come closer to meeting the budget this year than ever before. Service involves responsibility, and it is apparent that through our Legacy of Service and its servants, more and more A. A. members are becoming aware of the responsibility and are therefore anxious to share in it.

Implementing the suggestions made in the Third Legacy Manual, that one day there should be cross linkage between the many Service Boards which could develop throughout the world, the General Service Board this year extended an invitation to the General Service Boards of Great Britain & Ireland, Ltd., Suomen AA-Kerhojen in Finland, Sentralledelsen in Norway and Stichting Werkgrepen in Holland, to send this year or next a member as a correspondent who would be a member of the Conference without vote, and as such would receive all Conference material. A member from Norway took part in the 1959 Conference on this basis and an "observer" for Holland was also present. Great Britain, Finland, and Holland have written of their desire to participate, and will select members to attend the 1960 Conference.

TRUSTEES OF THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD

(Cal M., Secretary)

The Board of Trustees meets quarterly, on the last Monday in April, July, October and January. Reports from the various Committees of the Board are heard and recommendations from these Committees are acted upon after considerable discussion and due consideration. Committees presently reporting are: Finance and Budgetary, Grapevine, Literature, Policy, Public Information, Nominating, 1960 Convention.

Other old, as well as new, business, is also acted upon. Practically all of these actions are reported to the Fellowship through the various Committees reporting at the General Service Conference. Among the other matters initiated at the Board meetings were the following:

1. The Nominating Committee was instructed to advise the Assemblies in the State of Minnesota of their responsibility to nominate an Area A. A. Trustee to succeed E. D. Sheridan. This was in accordance with the plan approved by the Conference in St. Louis in 1955; The Committee was instructed to confer with the General Service Conference regarding the nomination of a General Service A. A. Trustee, to succeed Cal J. McCarthy, Jr., from the A. A. Publishing, Inc. Board.
2. The Board accepted the invitation of Long Beach, California, for the 25th Anniversary International Convention, with the proviso that groups in the State of Cali-

fornia raise funds of \$10,000 as an underwriting guarantee against loss.

3. Approval was given to a recommendation that the General Service Conference adopt the following procedure:

"That, when a motion is made from the floor of the General Service Conference, requiring the expenditure of monies not provided in the budget, the Chairman shall immediately refer the motion to a joint Conference and Trustees Committee on Finance which shall consider the motion and recommend to the Conference such action thereon as it may deem wise."

4. The Board approved the establishment of an entity to be called A. A. General Services, Inc. through which would be cleared all funds previously accounted for by: (a) General Fund of the General Service Board; (b) Group Fund of the General Service Board; (c) A. A. Publishing, Inc. In effect, the only remaining fund of the General Service Board would then be the Reserve Fund. The A. A. Grapevine, Inc. would, however, remain a separate entity. This is to be effected in accordance with the advice of counsel.
5. The Board authorized that funds be transferred from the General Fund to the Group Fund to the extent of the deficit in group contributions for the year 1958.

GENERAL SERVICE OFFICE OPERATIONS

(Hank G., Chairman, G. S. Committee)

There continues to be increased activity in the G. S. O. as reflected in the following tabulations for 1958: (In nearly all cases the totals are higher than for the preceding year.)

INCOMING MAIL ITEMS 49,995
(Inquiries, Group Communications, Contributions, etc.)

OUTGOING MAIL ITEMS 159,580
(Including Monthly Bulletins—10,000 per month)

PACKAGES WRAPPED AND SHIPPED 25,708
(34,800 books, 743,811 pamphlets, 190 record sets,
212,371 wallet cards)

The accounting department processed 9,600 orders for books, pamphlets, etc. and handled 8,640 contribution remittances.

Distribution of Books, Pamphlets and Miscellaneous Items in 1958

Books

Alcoholics Anonymous (Old Edition)	71
Alcoholics Anonymous (Revised Edition)	20,585
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions	7,282
Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age	6,862

Total Books Shipped 34,800

Pamphlets

This is A. A.	86,366
A. A.—44 Questions & Answers	79,618
Is A. A. for You?	95,864
Partners in A. A. (New 4/58)	33,555
Young People and A. A.	29,501
A. A. for the Woman	29,732
A. A. Tradition—How it Developed	19,036
Sponsorship (Discontinued)	10,343
Questions & Answers on Sponsorship (New 4/58)	33,163

Pamphlets (Continued)

Alcoholism the Illness	44,674
The Alcoholic Husband	45,668
The Alcoholic Wife	33,837
The Alcoholic Employee	18,228
A. A. & the Medical Profession	29,573
A. A.—Helpful Ally in Coping with Alcoholism	30,434
Sedatives and the Alcoholic	29,313
Saturday Evening Post Reprint	32,757
Fortune Reprint	24,676
Good Housekeeping Reprint	28,003
The Third Legacy Manual	5,362
Foreign Translations	4,108

Total Pamphlets Shipped 743,811

Miscellaneous

Wallet Cards—old	212,371
Wallet Cards—two-part (New)	27,800
Parchment Scrolls	795
Lasker Award Replicas	30
Books—"A. A.", Spanish	168

Records

Milestones Ahead	66
A. A.'s Three Legacies	77
A. A.'s Traditions	47

Total Record Sets Shipped 190

Thirty full-time and one part-time persons are employed at G. S. O. in the following categories: A. A. Staff (7); Stenographic, filing, telephone and reception (12); Accounting (4½) and Shipping (7).

1960 CONVENTION

(Hank G., Chairman)

The following have been designated officers of the 1960 Convention Committee by the General Service Board:

HENRY F. GRIEME, - *Chairman*

HERBERT A. MORSE - *Public Relations Chairman*

HAZEL RICE - *Secretary*

They will work with four key Committees:

1. *Convention Advisory Committee of the Conference:* The basic responsibility of this Committee is to guide the G. S. O. on general policy and to encourage attendance from areas throughout the United States and Canada.
2. *California Convention Registration Committee:* The basic responsibility of this Committee was to obtain a minimum of 2,000 California registrations during February and March of 1959. A registration fee of \$5.00 per person was decided upon.
The response among members in the State of California was most active and resulted in advance registrations amounting to more than \$10,000, which will provide a substantial underwriting fund for Convention expenses.
3. *Local Host Committee:* This Committee will be designated by the Long Beach and Los Angeles Areas. The specific responsibility of this Committee shall be to coordinate and have available plans for sightseeing, entertainment, etc.

4. *Convention Public Relations Committee:* This Convention Committee will include members of the General Service Board's Public Information Committee, and at least five local California members—one from each of the five areas. These members are being proposed by the respective Committees in California.

General Policy

Supervision of programming and public relations for the Convention is being retained by the General Service Board. Any excess of income over expenses will be turned over to the Reserve Fund of the General Service Board.

Public relations for the Convention shall be keyed to the concept of attracting the widest possible interest in A. A.'s 25th anniversary as a means of making existence of the A. A. recovery program known to many who may need the help A. A. can offer.

After details have been completed, housing reservation forms will be provided the General Service Office by the Long Beach Convention Bureau. The General Service Office will send these forms to all groups about January 1, 1960, incorporating all necessary procedures. Meanwhile, all housing in Long Beach has been blocked out by the Convention Bureau and held for the official reservation plan to be announced.

PUBLIC INFORMATION COMMITTEE

(Herb M., Chairman)

The Public Information Committee (PIC) is a sub-committee of the Policy Committee and serves in an advisory capacity. It undertakes to clarify specific points of public relations policy to guide the General Service Office. It supports the "Movement-Wide Public Information Policy" approved by the 1956 Conference:

"In all public relationships, A. A.'s sole objective is to help the still suffering alcoholic. Always mindful of the importance of personal anonymity, we believe this can be done by making known to him, and to those who may be interested in his problems, our own experience as individuals and as a Fellowship in learning to live without alcohol. We believe that our experience should be made available freely to all who express sincere interest. We believe further that all our efforts in this field should always reflect our gratitude for the gift of sobriety and our awareness that many outside A. A. are equally concerned with the serious problem of alcoholism."

During the past year, the P. I. C. was called on for a practical application of this policy. For the first time, G. S. O. was asked by one of the TV networks (Columbia Broadcasting System) to cooperate in the production of a major television program "Playhouse 90." P. I. C. made the following recommendations, which were approved by the Policy Committee and the General Service Board:

1. That a "Playhouse 90" dramatization, done with G. S. O. cooperation, would give A. A. the kind of public exposure it wants.
2. That G. S. O. should cooperate, as it does with any publisher, writer, etc., who asks for information
3. a) That in the event that CBS would want to carry a credit line, "Made in cooperation with the General Service Board." G. S. O. should have a contract providing needed "approval rights," and;

- b) That in the event CBS is not interested in a G. S. B. credit, G. S. O. should be prepared to work with them and to file criticism whenever G. S. O. questions the validity of their treatment of A. A. Should this criticism be ignored, G. S. O. should be prepared to give CBS written notice of discontinuance of cooperation.

Subsequently, when advance copies of the script were made available to the Public Information Committee, all suggestions made to the author and producer were followed. There was no request for the use of a credit line involving the General Service Board. With the success of this network program, the Public Information Committee, at its following meeting, recommended that the procedures outlined above continue to be over-all G. S. O. policy in reference to inquiries from TV networks.

In January, G. S. O. was asked to cooperate with Screen Gems, in the making of a series to be titled "Alcoholics Anonymous." The Committee recommended deferring action on this request, pending receipt of more detailed information on the proposed series.

The Committee recommended continuance of the policy of showing the "professional exhibit" only at national meetings.

It also recommended that a sum not to exceed \$500 be made available (as well as all information about our Public Information display) in the event that the General Service Board of Great Britain and Ireland, Ltd., wishes assistance in the creation of a display for the World Health Conference to be held in Scotland in 1960.

The Committee recommended that the 25th Anniversary year be utilized as an opportunity for encouraging editorial recognition of A. A. in the U. S. and Canada. It was felt that if we do not take leadership in such a program, the anniversary may be seized on by others as a basis for less accurate news accounts dealing with A. A.'s development. Accordingly, a working group has been set up to guide and develop anniversary publicity, as distinguished from publicity centering on the Convention itself.

GROUP RECORDS AND DIRECTORY

(Anita R.)

The improvement in maintaining contact with groups is most encouraging. It is evident the work of the Delegates and Committeemen is helping to make the groups want to keep in touch with their General Service Office. And as had been hoped, they are becoming more aware of the importance of returning information for proper listing.

Only by keeping in touch with all groups, central offices, clubs, lone members and Internationalists can G. S. O. serve as a clearing house for A. A. news and reflect an over-all picture of the Fellowship. By working together G. S. O. can publish a World Directory which makes it possible for members throughout the world to turn quickly and directly to each other whenever the need arises. And for all A. A.s, the Directory might be considered a symbol of growth and unity.

It seems indicated that definite consideration be given to listing meeting nights in the next issue. It now seems feasible to add a space for this information on the simplified group registration card. In some instances the meeting night is already included in the group name. It might be added just following the name in other cases without adding bulk to the Directory.

Cooperation of the groups has been excellent in obtaining

post office boxes as permanent mailing addresses whenever practical. In metropolitan areas, it is usually preferable to have mail sent to the General Service Representative or to the meeting place.

As in the past, groups were inactivated automatically if there was no contact with them during the past year via an Information Card, letter, order, contribution or listing by a Central Office, Delegate or Committeeman. The number inactivated and omitted from the 1959 Directory was much smaller than in 1958.

Special forms for obtaining census figures were mailed to all groups with the September and October Exchange Bulletins. The active membership for directory listing was asked for, as well as a total membership to include members not usually counted because they might not participate regularly in group activities. More than fifty per cent of the groups returned the special census figures. This has provided a basis for compiling a more accurate total for use in public information. This survey also assisted in bringing group records up to date.

Although G. S. O. will always have problems in obtaining and maintaining effective contact with the groups, the gradual progress being made is very gratifying.

PUBLIC INFORMATION ACTIVITIES

(Eve M.)

Following the recommendation of the Public Information Committee, the first step toward the "Playhouse 90" production, made at the request of both Fred Coe, the producer, and J. P. Miller, the author, was to provide Mr. Miller with as complete an understanding of A. A. as possible. Arrangements were made for him to attend both open and closed meetings and visits were made with A. A. members to both Bellevue Hospital and Towns Hospital.

After the initial script was approved and rehearsals had started, it was found that fifteen minutes needed to be cut. The G. S. O. staff member handling public relations flew to the Coast for the final week of rehearsals. The cooperation given her by Fred Coe, John Frankenheimer, J. P. Miller and the entire "Playhouse 90" staff was indicative of their high regard for the principles and purposes of Alcoholics Anonymous.

Following the telecast all Intergroups were polled to determine whether the program had attracted additional inquiries. Many reported an increase in the number of calls immediately after the program, and new members were reported as a result of "The Days of Wine and Roses". CBS reported to G. S. O. that the program stimulated the greatest response accorded any "Playhouse 90" production. A copy of a letter received at G. S. O. from Fred Coe, follows this report.

The "professional exhibit" was shown last year at the American Tuberculous Association, the American Nurses Association, the American Medical Association and the American Correctional Congress. It will be shown in 1959 at the National Nurses Association, The American Medical Association, the American Public Health Association and the National Conference on Social Welfare. Volunteer committees are being asked to cover each meeting. Letters go to those individuals who have viewed the display and who have requested additional information about A. A.

The anonymity mailing requested by the General Service Conference of 1958 was undertaken in the Fall. More than 7500 editors, broadcasters and others in the communications media were reached.

The value of this continued education of the press on the purpose and meaning of our tradition of anonymity is suggested by the following letter from The Winslow (Arizona) "Mail:"

"It has just come to our attention that we published a story in our issue of February 27th which identified a member of your organization. I'm writing to you to apologize. We have the highest regard for Alcoholics Anonymous and we would not willingly do anything to hamper its services to those wise enough to ally themselves with A. A."

The National Industrial Conference Board, Inc., published a special report on "The Alcoholic Worker." The report included a full discussion of Alcoholics Anonymous, and the authors cooperated with G. S. O. in the writing and editing of this material.

Acknowledging inquiries continues to be a part of our public information service. The past year brought approximately 3700 general inquiries. Approximately 800 have been orders for books or pamphlet material. The greater number (2900) have been letters seeking specific answers. Roughly 30% of these letters have come from students and teachers. The bulk of the remaining inquiries came from members of an alcoholic's family, clergymen and individual alcoholics. Inquiries have also been received from industry, doctors, nurses, government agencies and temperance societies. A number of requests for information originated overseas.

CBS TELEVISION NETWORK

Television City - Hollywood, California

November 12, 1958

Mr. Leonard Harrison
Box 155

Old Lyme, Connecticut

Dear Mr. Harrison:

A delayed but nonetheless abundant note of gratitude and sincere appreciation for the help and advice that your New York organization of Alcoholics Anonymous gave to our production of J. P. Miller's story, "The Days of Wine and Roses"—and a deep bow to Miss Eve Marsh, whose advice to the writer, director, and actors was so helpful.

"The Days of Wine and Roses" received the largest mail, telephone and telegram response of any program presented on PLAYHOUSE 90. Such a response is always gratifying, and I feel that your association should certainly receive a large share of the praise. My whole staff joins me in a grateful "thank you."

Sincerely,
Fred Coe

G. S. B. FINANCE & BUDGETARY COMMITTEE

Operations of A. A.'s General Service agencies resulted in a net income of \$15,583 in 1958 as compared with a net loss of \$1,629 in 1957.

A. A. Publishing, Inc. earned \$39,889 of which \$30,000 was paid in dividends to the General Fund.

The A. A. Grapevine operations resulted in a net loss of \$2,799.

Group contributions in 1958 were \$188,348 as compared with \$169,042 collected in 1957. The 1958 contributions failed by \$6,347 to meet office and Conference expenses. The sum of \$6,347 was transferred from the General Fund to make up this deficit.

The above figures are exclusive of additions to the Reserve Fund of \$14,324 from book discounts donated.

(See detailed financial data on pages 24-26.)

SUGGESTED SHARE OF 1959 BUDGET

Based on an estimated budget of \$203,500 and using the 1958 membership as a factor, the share of each state and province for the year 1959 is apportioned in the following schedule. For budget purposes, only groups in the United States and Canada have been estimated.

U. S. A.	1958 Member- ship	Per Capita 1959 Budget	State & Province Share	STATE	1958 Member- ship	Per Capita 1959 Budget	State & Province Share
Alabama	1,069	\$1.85	\$ 1,980	New York	7,473	"	13,820
Alaska	164	"	305	North Carolina	2,173	"	4,020
Arizona	650	"	1,200	North Dakota	469	"	870
Arkansas	779	"	1,440	Ohio	7,876	"	14,570
California	15,255	"	28,220	Oklahoma	1,259	"	2,330
Colorado	1,145	"	2,120	Oregon	885	"	1,635
Connecticut	1,535	"	2,840	Pennsylvania	3,427	"	6,340
Delaware	251	"	465	Rhode Island	198	"	365
District of Columbia	495	"	915	South Carolina	1,029	"	1,905
Florida	3,040	"	5,620	South Dakota	646	"	1,195
Georgia	920	"	1,700	Tennessee	868	"	1,605
Idaho	351	"	650	Texas	5,357	"	9,910
Illinois	6,623	"	12,250	Utah	752	"	1,390
Indiana	1,960	"	3,620	Vermont	319	"	590
Iowa	1,496	"	2,765	Virginia	1,826	"	3,380
Kansas	1,437	"	2,660	Washington	1,620	"	2,990
Kentucky	863	"	1,595	West Virginia	583	"	1,080
Louisiana	1,090	"	2,015	Wisconsin	1,811	"	3,350
Maine	517	"	955	Wyoming	218	"	405
Maryland	1,510	"	2,790	TOTAL FOR U. S. A.	98,858	\$1.85	\$182,835
Massachusetts	2,939	"	5,440	CANADA			
Michigan	4,860	"	8,990	Alberta	808	\$1.85	\$ 1,495
Minnesota	3,877	"	7,170	British Columbia	1,857	"	3,430
Mississippi	578	"	1,070	Manitoba	724	"	1,340
Missouri	2,151	"	3,980	New Brunswick	386	"	715
Montana	407	"	750	Newfoundland	113	"	210
Nebraska	494	"	915	Nova Scotia	547	"	1,010
Nevada	373	"	690	Ontario	3,930	"	7,270
New Hampshire	277	"	500	Prince Edward Isle	156	"	285
New Jersey	2,485	"	4,590	Quebec	1,963	"	3,630
New Mexico	478	"	885	Saskatchewan	648	"	1,190
				Yukon Territory	30	"	55
				Northwest Territories	19	"	35
				TOTAL FOR CANADA	11,181	\$1.85	\$ 20,665
				TOTAL FOR U. S. A & CANADA	110,039	\$1.85	\$203,500

G. S. O. POLICY COMMITTEE

(John P. L., Chairman)

The Policy Committee meets quarterly on the Sunday preceding each General Service Board Meeting. While there are ten voting members, all other Trustees, General Service Office, A. A. Publishing and Grapevine Directors, plus Staff Members, are invited to attend. The Chairman is traditionally an Alcoholic Area Trustee. Recommendations are presented to the board with both majority and minority (if any) opinions.

Recommendations during the past year included the following:

1. That the Board approve the new description of Alcoholics Anonymous as contained in the "Helpful Ally" leaflet, thereby making it the official definition of the Fellowship for use in all literature, including the Grapevine.
2. That no further clarification of General Service Office policy regarding the use of the Directory for A. A. purposes be made; that the General Service Office place use of the Directory on the agenda for discussion at the 1959 Conference; and that the customary "misuse of Directory" letters be *not* written except in flagrant cases or upon direction of the Policy Committee.
3. That the General Service Conference adopt the following procedure: "When a motion is made from the floor of the General Service Conference requiring the expenditure of monies not provided in the budget, the Chairman shall immediately refer the motion to a joint Conference and Trustees Committee on Finance which shall consider the motion and recommend to the Conference such action thereon as it may deem wise."
4. In connection with the General Service Conference:
 - a) That, inasmuch as no proposals have been received other than that relating to the "Trustee ratio" prior to the January meeting, as required, no other discussion subjects be listed on the agenda.
 - b) That the Secretary of the Conference, in her opening remarks, advise Delegates of such suggestions that have been received for probable discussion.
 - c) That the Conference Chairman, when subjects are raised for discussion, give such time as he thinks appropriate for consideration and then refer them to the

appropriate Committee. The Committee, after consideration, is then to make a final recommendation for Conference action.

- d) That, insofar as possible, the Board of Trustees will be prepared to express its opinion on such subjects.
- e) That the Board of Trustees reserve the right to request postponement of final action in the event of their having had no opportunity to consider a proposal which is raised on the floor.
- f) That the Trustees and other non-Area Delegates assume the responsibility of considering discussion subjects in advance of the Conference.
- g) That any member of the Conference has the right to introduce into the Conference any discussion subject he deems appropriate.
- h) That, in summation, the relationship of the Board of Trustees to the Conference include the following:
 - 1) The submission to the Areas of proposals for consideration by the groups.
 - 2) Board Members may wish to advise the Conference of their opinions on matters which may arise.
 - 3) Expression by the Board to the Conference of its opinion on matters which are coming or will come before the Conference for consideration.
5. The Committee recommends that an invitation be extended to the General Service Boards of Great Britain & Ireland, Ltd., Suomen A.A.-Kerhojen in Finland, Sentralledelsen in Norway and Stichting Werkgroepen in Holland, to send this year or next a member as a correspondent who would be a member of the Conference without vote, and as such would receive all Conference material. Further, that those persons appointed as foreign observers in the past be permitted to attend the 1959 Conference, but that no additional foreign observers be appointed. All corresponding members and observers are to pay their own travel, hotel bill and meals other than those furnished for Conference Delegates.

G. S. B. NOMINATING COMMITTEE

(Dr. John L. Norris, Chairman)

The Nominating Committee recommends that, subject to the approval of the 1959 General Service Conference, Sumner Campbell and Pat Cronin be elected to fill the Class B. Trustee vacancies. The Committee further recommends that, subject to the approval of the 1959 General Service Conference, the following be nominated for election as Class A Trustees:

Frank Gulden
Leonard V. Harrison
Dr. John L. Norris
Archibald B. Roosevelt
Bernard B. Smith
Dr. Harry M. Tiebout
Harrison M. Trice
L. Ivan Underwood

And the following be nominated for election as Class B Trustees:

Charlie Brown
John Park Lee
Sumner Campbell
Pat Cronin
Alfred Steckman
Herbert A. Morse
Richard Stevens

And further, that subject to the approval of the 1959 General Service Conference the following officers of the General Service Board be elected:

Chairman Leonard V. Harrison
1st Vice-Chairman Dr. John L. Norris
2nd Vice-Chairman Herbert A. Morse
Treasurer Archibald B. Roosevelt
Secretary Richard A. Stevens

THE A. A. GRAPEVINE

The year 1958 saw a great many developments in the editorial, business and corporate life of the magazine:

An Editorial Board of fifteen was set up and has been holding monthly meetings since September.

A readership questionnaire returned by readers indicated general approval of the present editorial direction.

An individual promotion plan, using the "I Like It" folders displayed at last year's Conference, was tested by delegates.

The first International Issue, in October, was described in correspondence and personal contact as an effective way of carrying the message of worldwide service; it will be an annual special issue.

Total income was higher in 1958 than in 1957, despite a total circulation decline of 12.3%, since all "newsstand sales" and three-fourths of all subscriptions in 1958 benefited from the higher price established in mid-1957.

Expansion of the Board of Directors from five members to seven was approved by the State of New York in June, and the transfer of Grapevine stock to the General Service Board authorized.

The Circulation and Business Office was moved to new quarters at the same address as the Editorial Department and G. S. O.

The size of the magazine reverted to 48 pages with the November issue, effecting a substantial saving in printing costs over the 64-page format.

MORE REQUESTS FOR REPRINTS

A marked increase was noted in requests to reprint Grapevine articles, notably Bill W.'s "Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends" series and also his "Emotional Sobriety," as well as "Give My Regards to New York," a personal view of the meaning of general service by a Los Angeles member. Bill's article in the April issue on "Leadership in A. A." will be reprinted by G. S. O.

Grapevine staffers and volunteers participated in Saturday "Open House" for GSRs from New York and New Jersey on two occasions.

An up-dated re-issue of the popular "Miniature Grapevines" has been prepared for free distribution at State and Area meetings.

The Editorial Office received a total of 1,749 letters and manuscripts in 1958, as compared to 1,200 the previous year.

The introduction of cartoons in each issue has been an increasingly popular attraction for both old and new readers.

The Grapevine Editor and staff members have participated in Area meetings on a wider scale than formerly.

A program of attracting material of interest to older members is under way, sparked by the Editorial Board.

A substantial reduction in promotion activity was effected, with a monetary saving of \$5,300 in 1958.

Promotional contact with groups and subscribers was maintained, however, through several means:

- a sample copy was mailed, with a letter from Bill, to non-subscribing groups.
- "percolation letters" were sent to Secretaries of non-subscribing groups in September, October and November.
- beginning in August, two pages of each issue carried informative material and an order blank.
- a leaflet introducing the magazine and its staff was mailed to all groups in December.

	A. A.		% Ratio
United States	Membership	Circulation	Subscribers
Alabama	1,257	215	17%
Alaska	193	64	33
Arizona	687	240	35
Arkansas	1,042	302	29
California	17,954	3,400	19
Colorado	1,490	342	23
Connecticut	1,659	534	32
Delaware	306	91	30
Washington D. C.	535	282	53
Florida	3,290	961	29
Georgia	1,062	323	30
Idaho	399	144	36
Illinois	7,162	1,377	19
Indiana	2,664	598	22
Iowa	1,812	483	27
Kansas	1,756	560	32
Kentucky	1,034	258	25
Louisiana	1,232	321	26
Maine	580	228	39
Maryland	1,637	464	28
Massachusetts	3,743	1,310	35
Michigan	5,932	1,429	24
Minnesota	4,159	792	19
Mississippi	746	254	34
Missouri	2,278	611	27
Montana	474	154	32
Nebraska	628	198	32
Nevada	411	105	26
New Hampshire	291	94	33
New Jersey	2,969	1,195	40
New Mexico	528	190	36
New York	9,094	3,059	34
North Carolina	2,426	645	27
North Dakota	544	172	32
Ohio	9,128	1,736	19
Oklahoma	1,469	453	31
Oregon	1,018	325	32
Pennsylvania	3,920	1,227	32
Rhode Island	263	70	27
South Carolina	1,089	295	27
South Dakota	726	188	26
Tennessee	923	215	23
Texas	6,200	1,540	25
Utah	800	225	28
Vermont	355	157	44
Virginia	1,932	601	31
Washington	1,990	554	28
West Virginia	621	217	35
Wisconsin	2,282	645	28
Wyoming	299	85	29
TOTALS for U. S.	114,989	29,928	26%
Canada			
Alberta	888	359	40%
British Columbia	1,978	516	26
Manitoba	899	318	35
New Brunswick	492	137	28
Nova Scotia & Nfld	660	203	31
Northwest Terr.	19	10	53
Ontario	4,194	1,614	38
Prince Edward Island	156	39	25
Quebec	2,244	353	16
Saskatchewan	711	299	42
Yukon Terr.	30	—	—
TOTALS for Canada	12,271	3,848	31%
United States Possessions			
Hawaii	179	—	—
Canal Zone	63	—	—
Puerto Rico	205	—	—
Virgin Islands	5	—	—
TOTALS	425	97	21%
FOREIGN	15,265	560	4%

NOTE: Grapevine circulation figures as of March 2;
A. A. membership figures as of April 9, 1959

GROUP RELATIONS AND INTERNATIONALISTS

(Ann M.)

INTERNATIONALISTS:

This year has seen a return of the old Internationalists special Bulletin, distributed monthly or every two months, dependent on the amount of material available. The Bulletin is composed of excerpts from the letters of the Group members themselves and often takes on the character of a "closed meeting".

There are presently 165 Internationalist members. As in the past, these A.A.s have shown themselves most devoted to the services provided by G.S.O. and have continued to contribute far more than three dollars a year to the Group Fund. They are wonderful ambassadors of A.A. Since they travel the world, they are carriers of our message of hope in many a remote spot. A quotation from a recent letter speaks more clearly than any editorial comment: "In Bombay, India about a year ago I and two Indians sat on a sea wall and talked. These two Indians were alcoholics and both school teachers. They wanted to stay sober. They had very little information and very little literature. My next trip to Bombay, the group had grown to six. On my next visit there were not only 25 members but the government had admitted that there is an alcohol problem and had asked the group for help. I received a letter recently in Boston. They now have ten additional members and they showed a film at an open meeting and 500 people attended. And a year ago three of us sat on a sea wall and talked about A.A.".

The Twelfth Step work carried on by Internationalists has a special meaning and helps materially in the growth of A.A. around the world.

Another bit from a letter illustrates vividly the part that G.S.O. plays in keeping the group a growing and going concern: "Many and many a time arriving in some strange port and feeling alone, a bright ray of sunshine would come aboard, a letter with the return address P. O. Box 459, and those letters I cherished as if they were my very life."

To share experience through letters is a part of the strength of this correspondence group. Up-to-date listings of the members, with their ship's names, are prepared periodically by G.S.O. and are indispensable to this sharing.

GROUP RELATIONS

The Group Relations assignment consists of keeping a weather eye out to see what services might be developed at G.S.O. that could be of increased help to groups and members. It has long been suggested, for instance, that material particularly tailored to the need of Loners, be prepared. To explore this possibility, a questionnaire has been sent out to Loners. From the answers received so far, it would seem possible to develop material from Loners to be given to Loners—a sharing of experience among those who actually know what it means to be a Loner and who have the best approach to attaining and maintaining sobriety in difficult circumstances.

The possibility of a special service for our Armed Forces groups is also being explored. It has been suggested that a bulletin might be prepared in which letters and material from the group members could be incorporated to help all service groups and assist in the formation of others. Specific problems having to do with necessary Armed Forces regulations are to be met.

GROUP PROBLEMS

Some typical questions follow:

- 1) How do you start an Intergroup?
- 2) Can you give us suggestions for a State Conference?
- 3) Please give us names of speakers for our Annual Banquet.
- 4) The townspeople have collected money in the name of George S. (A.A. member deceased) to give to our group in his memory. Shall we accept it?
- 5) The group has been asked to participate in a meeting of the State Commission on Alcoholism; should we accept the invitation?
- 6) A radio station has offered us five minute daily spots for A.A. What can we do with the time?
- 7) A man purporting to be an A.A. member has been "conning" the groups in this area. What can be done about it?
- 8) Warden R. has approached our group for information on starting a group in the State prison. Can you help us?
- 9) Some of our members are anxious to approach the State legislature for funds to start a hospital for alcoholics. Is this right?
- 10) The wife (non-alcoholic) of one of our good members insists on attending closed meetings. Some of the members don't want her. What should we do?

These and many other questions are received and answered in the light of A.A. tradition and the shared experience of many groups now available in G.S.O. files.

The *Exchange Bulletin* wears a new face since January first. Response from the groups seems to indicate that the new informality and personal approach is finding acceptance. The saving in expense is considerable.

Routing the six copies of the film *Case 258* to A.A. groups and to non-A.A.s interested in seeing the film is a continuing part of our services. The films wear out fast and last year through the generosity of Procter and Gamble we were given four brand new films.

FOREIGN RELATIONS — A. A. OVERSEAS

(Lyb S.)

A. A. overseas continues to follow the traditional pattern of growth. Australian A. A. has reached the stage where it is forming a General Service Conference. Other areas have organized and strengthened Central Service Offices and Committees and in some overseas lands A. A. has just gotten started.

ENGLAND: The General Service Board of Great Britain and Ireland is preparing an order blank, listing literature available through A. A. Publishing (Great Britain and Ireland) Ltd. G. S. O. will cooperate in its distribution to groups in the Sterling Area. This will make it possible for certain countries with money restrictions to have a wider selection of Conference-approved literature. The first prison group was started at Wakeville prison and several others are in the process of forming.

HOLLAND: More than 500 A. A.s, their families and other interested non-alcoholics attended the 10th Anniversary Conference of A. A. in Holland last September. A feature of the meeting was a presentation of a tape recording by Bill, whose English text had been translated into Dutch by Adrian, the former G. S. Conference Delegate from South Eastern New York.

BELGIUM: Though small in number and not too old in years, A. A. in Brussels maintained a club for A. A.s visiting the International Exhibition in Brussels, from April through September, 1958. It was publicized through the A. A. Exchange Bulletin and the information given to many traveling A. A. members. Seven new groups were formed in Belgium last year. The Brussels Group started a mimeographed French newsletter and prepared a French introductory pamphlet based on Chapter 5 of the Big Book.

FRANCE & GERMANY: A. A. in these two countries consists mostly of Armed Service Groups and Loners. The Moehnesee Canadian Group at Soest, Germany, published an 8-panel pocket folder describing A. A. and the Group's operation. The Secretary has shared it, as well as detailed reports, with Armed Forces Groups all over the world. G. S. O. has asked him to write to groups from Casablanca, in North Africa to Fiji in the South Pacific.

NORWAY: Translation of the Norwegian A. A. Book has been completed and it is now being printed in Norway, by agreement with A. A. Publishing, Inc. Thanks to the cooperation of Sentralledelsen (A. A. General Service Committee for Norway) and Hart S., the translation is a very good one. In the past year, the Sentralledelsen has strengthened its contact with the groups in Norway. Following the G. S. O. procedure of distributing a sample of new literature, it distributed copies of a new Norwegian Serenity Prayer to the groups in Norway.

FINLAND: The Suomen A. A. Kerhojen (A. A. General Service Committees for Finland) translated and distributed the 1958 World Directory to all Finnish Groups, and increased their bulletin service from one to two a month. This allows them to translate and include more news from the A. A. Exchange Bulletin.

SOVIET RUSSIA: After an exchange of letters with Dr. Lidia Bogdonanovich, Senior Scientific Worker of the Academy of Medical Science of U. S. S. R., in Moscow, G. S. O. sent her all three A. A. books and one copy of each pamphlet distributed by A. A. Publishing, Inc. She wrote that she would inform the scientists of Moscow about the contents of our books.

UNION OF SOUTH AFRICA: Last year, following discussion at the Annual South African A. A. Conference, The Service & Information Committee started a special service patterned after

the G. S. O.'s Loner Sponsorship Service. A. A. in South Africa is growing. For example: In Zululand there are now 5 groups and 4 Loners, an increase over last year's two groups and one Loner.

INDIA: "Patterns of A. A. — Hospital Cooperation" and "Hospital Administrators Evaluate A. A." helped the Bombay group get hospitalization for alcoholics. A local hospital has given the group a priority for alcoholics in a separate ward with two beds.

SINGAPORE: The group in Singapore is a year old. It has almost completed translation of Chapter 5 of the Big Book into Chinese, and will soon start translating it into Malay.

FIJI ISLANDS: A. A. in the Fiji Islands has grown in the last year from one Lone Member to two groups and two Loners.

NEW ZEALAND: In the last year A. A. in New Zealand has established three Intergroup Offices, and the groups have grown from 34 to 50. A new club in Auckland was listed, and we have registered 4 Lone Members.

AUSTRALIA: The first All-Australian Convention was held in January, 1959. At the closing business meeting, it was agreed with enthusiasm that a Service Conference for Australia be established. A simple constitution guided by the "Third Legacy Manual" with State Representation is now being prepared.

JAPAN: The Iwakuni Group in Japan had the Twelve Steps and the description of A. A. translated into Japanese (Kanji). A recent letter reports that two of the Japanese sponsored last September are still sober, and are attending meetings regularly.

CARIBBEAN ISLANDS: CENTRAL AMERICA: SOUTH AMERICA: A. A. is growing by leaps and bounds in many Spanish-speaking countries. Some groups have translated A. A. Publishing pamphlets into Spanish, or have prepared their own Spanish introductory pamphlet. A newsletter in Spanish is distributed by the Arthur Group in Buenos Aires, Argentina. The same newsletter is translated into Papiemento in the Netherlands Antilles, and a Portuguese newsletter is distributed by the Gruppo Central, in Rio De Janeiro, to groups in Brazil.

SUMMARY: In serving A. A. overseas last year, G. S. O. . . .

1. Continued to send pamphlets and service material wherever needed.
2. Granted permission to groups to translate A. A. Publishing literature into Spanish, French, Afrikaans, Finnish, Swahili, Chinese and Japanese.
3. Provided lists of contacts for 33 travelling A. A.s.
4. Arranged sponsorship-by-correspondence for 27 English-speaking Loners, 2 French, 1 German and 12 Spanish-speaking new members.
5. Received the following visitors and explained how A. A. cooperates with other agencies . . . The Chairman of Metal Hygiene for Australia, the Directors of Public Health for New Zealand, the Director-General of Health and Medical Services in Queensland, Australia, and a Staff Member from the Bureau for Alcoholics in Amsterdam, Holland.
6. Worked with 4 volunteer members who translated correspondence and helped G. S. O. communicate with A. A. in Sweden, Holland, Norway and several Spanish-speaking countries.
7. Sent detailed information about the 1958 General Service Conference to the A. A. General Service Boards in England, Norway, Finland, Holland and to two pre-board Committees in South Africa and Australia.

INSTITUTIONAL A. A. (Prisons & Hospitals)

From correspondence received at G.S.O., it is evident that local Institutional Committees and Sponsorship programs are doing their customary excellent work with Institutional groups in their respective areas.

However, setting up a consistent program of A.A. meetings within an institution when A.A. groups are few and far between seems to present something of a problem. Two pitfalls make themselves apparent very soon. One is the burden of responsibility that falls on one or two people who are worked to death and on whom the Institutional authorities tend to rely exclusively. The second is that spasmodic efforts on the part of neighboring groups peter out to nothing because there has been no definite plan outlined for a follow through.

In other cases the Prison or Hospital Administrators are apt to become disillusioned or misinformed as to the part A.A. can play in rehabilitation. The oldtimers on whom the administrators have come to place too much reliance may get drunk, or get tired of the unceasing responsibility and the Administration feels let down.

An increased understanding, on the part of institutional administrators, of what A.A. can and cannot do within the institution and without, and shouldering of responsibility for the welfare of our institutional groups on the part of all A.A. (not just a handful) in the area where an Institutional Group is in existence, or is needed, should help in avoiding these pitfalls.

G.S.O. has been sending out many copies of *Hospital Administrators Evaluate A.A.* and *Correctional Officials Evaluate A.A.* to both administrators and A.A. members who are devoted to hospital and prison work.

More than 100 prison groups distribute publications that are received, digested and evaluated in an effort to keep abreast of

what is going on in the prison field and to help G.S.O. determine how it can serve these groups better.

Speakers from G.S.O. participated in anniversary meetings in both prisons and hospitals. An actual "look-see" is worth a thousand theoretical ideas.

Patterns of A.A. Hospital Cooperation is now available in pamphlet form, the format matching that of *Hospital Administrators and Correctional Officials Evaluate A.A.*; it is priced at \$.25.

New Hospital and Prison directories were mailed to all Institutional Groups on March first. The format has been changed and these directories are now available at \$.50 a copy.

The number of prison groups is growing overseas. A recent letter from the sponsor of the first English prison group testified to the value of *Correctional Officials Evaluate A.A.* He said that two letters were received by the London Newsletter from A.A.s who had appointments with prison governors, for the purpose of interesting these men in starting A.A. groups in their respective institutions. The letter states; "I've advised them to ask you (GSO) for a copy of *Correctional Officials Evaluate A.A.* This clinched things, I think, at Wakefield (first prison group). It has a wonderful sales appeal, to straight-laced British authorities. One feels sure it helped to cut the red tape.

"Progress is being made. Yesterday we held our first closed meeting at the prison. The men were escorted to the deputy governor's office, then left completely. The door was not locked, also the officer who brought them left to go to the Officers Club for a drink while we had our meeting."

So, as with every other aspect of our A.A. world we can close with the words "Progress is being made".

LITERATURE COMMITTEE

(Cal M., Chairman)

Literature Committee assignments during the past year included production of the monthly *A.A. Exchange Bulletin*, updating and revision of several existing pamphlets and folders, preparation of the 1958 Conference Report and the special "Conference Highlights" digest for the groups, as well as preparation of the Interim Reports distributed to Conference personnel.

The 1958 Conference requested that the Literature Committee

1. Prepare a letter on Anonymity —
7,500 letters were mailed out to the major communications media and included newspapers, magazines and radio and television stations.

2. Distribute specially-priced "literature packages" and report the results —

The dollar sales of pamphlets increased from \$64,000 to \$73,000 in spite of the lower "package" price. Furthermore, these packages provided a sampling of pamphlets that helped many groups become familiar with the broad scope of Conference-approved literature.

The December Interim Report carried an account of the decision of the Board of Trustees that the Literature Committees of the Conference and the General Service Board hold a joint meeting at the 1959 Conference, and that the Literature Consultant to the Board Literature Committee be an ex-officio member of the Conference Literature Committee.

Two items of special interest were produced.

1. "Alcoholism the Illness" was revised to include Bill's

most recent paper to the New York Society on Alcoholism, April 1958.

2. "Structure and Services" was revised and re-titled "Inside A.A." Both of these revised pamphlets will be found in your kits.

The revision of the "Sedatives" pamphlet is now almost ready. This project has taken a full year and is now in its third draft form. It should be ready some time this Spring and will include material on tranquilizers and several case histories of A.A. members who have had "pill" problems affecting their sobriety.

The 1958 Conference did *not* feel that there was a need for a special pamphlet for members in prisons and jails. However, some believe that there may be a need for such a pamphlet and the General Service Committee asked that a presentation on this subject be made to the joint Literature Committees at the 1959 Conference.

Furthermore, it is thought that there may also be a need for a pamphlet concerning the relationship of Alcoholics Anonymous and the clergy. Therefore, the General Service Committee asked that a presentation outlining the purpose and needs for this pamphlet be prepared and considered by the joint Literature Committees at the 1959 Conference.

Since there is a need to revise "The Alcoholic Employee" pamphlet, it has been suggested that a survey be made among Delegates to the 1960 Conference on industrial and business programs in their areas so that the General Service Office material can be brought up to date.

'AREA CONFERENCES AND CONVENTIONS'

Problems of Organization, Finance, Publicity

Problems of organization, finance and publicity were highlighted in a stimulating workshop session on "Area Conferences and Conventions." The panel presentation was moderated by Ladd S. of South and Southwestern Ohio, substituting for Viv. I. of South Carolina who was called home due to a death in his family.

SOUTH DAKOTA

In his opening talk, Tom Z. of South Dakota stressed the problems encountered in large, sparsely-settled States. South Dakota, one of the largest States in the Union, has an A.A. population of less than 700 and many groups are 100-200 miles from their nearest A.A. "neighbors."

Under such conditions, one of the most important things a Delegate can do, Tom noted, is to develop a strong personal correspondence program in behalf of State service conferences. Because South Dakota is primarily an agricultural State, not all members can attend a conference at the same time. To overcome this, his Area schedules two conferences a year. The average attendance recently at each of these two-day meetings has been more than one-half the total A.A. population in the State.

The host city group is responsible for programming the get-togethers, which conclude with a Sunday business session. Attendance at business sessions was low (30) in the beginning but as many as 175 members attended the most recent business meeting.

Tom reported that increased acceptance of the A.A. service concept in his Area had been responsible for introducing about 150 Indians to the recovery program.

ALABAMA

Ralph B. of Alabama intrigued his fellow Delegates with a report on success in staging conferences "without money."

In 1955 members in Alabama decided that it was time to strengthen their state-wide service structure by bringing members together for the first time.

It was decided to attempt to finance the Convention in advance, thereby eliminating a registration fee. Accordingly the 34 groups in the State were asked to make monthly pledges to defray costs of the forthcoming meeting. Thirty groups took part in the pledge program; of these, a few did not keep their pledges up to date "but they all sent in something." Friendly reminders were sent to the groups during the year. A surplus of nearly \$225 remained after the first convention.

Ralph said some groups pledge as little as \$2 or \$3 per month. Other pledges are as high as \$10 monthly. Every group has increased its pledge since the novel plan was inaugurated. (Visitors from outside Alabama pay a small registration fee.)

With between 800 to 900 active members, 356 Alabama A.A.s attended the first state-wide gathering and attendance has been above 400 at all subsequent meetings.

After each convention, the planning committee waits 30 days before seeking pledges for the convention a year later.

"This plan really works," Ralph emphasized. "Now we even get letters from groups that want to know where to send 'the Convention money.' A plan like this may sound unusual but it can be made to operate successfully if you just get people in the right habits."

ARIZONA

John D. of Arizona discussed problems encountered in developing a sound organization structure for State meetings.

In the early days in his Area, John said, the pioneer members more or less underwrote the conventions and the pioneer groups had dominant influence in planning and staging them.

Today the Third Legacy structure, operating through a G.S.R. Assembly, assures more widespread participation in Convention affairs. Committees on Finance, Agenda and on the Convention, together with various subcommittees, have made the planning more democratic. "The opinion of a single member is respected," John declared. "All members of the key committees are really trying to act as trusted servants. We want unity, not dissension. When a minority opinion develops, we try to fit it into the total picture."

In the future, Arizona meetings will be called "Conferences" rather than "Conventions," the members have agreed. They will be patterned after successful conferences in other states to the extent that they will include workshops, a banquet meeting, opportunities to handle questions raised anonymously etc.

SASKATCHEWAN

Cec C. of Saskatchewan reported that planned publicity techniques had been helpful in attracting newcomers, as well as A.A. members, to the open meetings featured at Area-wide gatherings in his Province.

Television stations in Regina, Saskatchewan and Saskatoon have all donated time as a public service to promote the meetings. The television programs ("Mr. Hope") simulate a regular A.A. meeting, with participants wearing masks.

Radio script material supplied by G.S.O. has been used to good effect also, Cec noted. Similarly, editorial material prepared by G.S.O. has been found useful in developing newspaper publicity. "Newspapers that were only mildly interested a few years back now compete for information on our A.A. meetings," Cec said.

Cec revealed a novel approach to the problem of handling details involved in public relations and publicity work when he reported that a local prison group has taken over these responsibilities. The inmates welcome the opportunity to send out notices and other material "and they have the time," Cec pointed out.

The result of the planned approach to publicity has been an influx of new members into A.A. in Saskatchewan, the Delegate said, with a substantial portion of the increase attributable to the television series.

Summarizing his panelists' presentations, Ladd S. suggested that State and Province meeting committees "should not be afraid to learn by trial and error." He reminded his listeners of the importance of having women members participate in meeting programs. "Treasurers should almost always be professional people, accustomed to handling money," he said. "The same is true of people selected to promote conferences. And, finally, there is one very sound way to cope with the problem of perennial 'grippers': isolate them and put them to work on your committee!"

'HELP AND HOPE FOR G. S. R.'

How Delegates Can Assist In Their Areas

"Help and Hope for the General Service Representative" was the subject of a provocative presentation at the Ninth General Service Conference. Lib L. of Oregon, who moderated the session, set the tone for the panel in his introductory remarks when he pointed out that Delegates, having been G. S. R.s themselves in many cases, can appreciate fully the importance of helping local service people.

South Florida

Wes P. of South Florida, the first speaker, noted that it was not enough for a Delegate to "carry the service story" to the groups; he must also follow through to be certain that the "story" has been understood and accepted.

A. A. in South Florida has had growth problems, he said, declaring that this was evident in the fact that 27 per cent of the groups in his Area had failed to submit up-to-date membership figures during a recent "audit." He had learned, he said, that it was important for a Delegate to follow up on G. S. R.s to let the latter know that their good service was appreciated—and also to encourage some Representatives who are apathetic to the A. A. world service story.

More frequent and better planned personal contacts between the South Florida Delegate and the Area G. S. R.s would be undertaken beginning June 1, Wes said.

Northeast Ohio

The G. S. R. is the most important person in the Northeast Ohio A. A. service structure, Al L., Delegate from that Area, emphasized in his talk. Steps taken in recent years to assure better liaison between the Groups and G. S. O. include the following:

1. Analysis of the Area A. A. population and its location. As a result, there was a re-districting of the Area Committee set-up and four new committeemen were added,
2. A complete and accurate mailing list of groups and G. S. R.s was created for G. S. O. and for the G. S. R.s themselves.
3. An interpretive bulletin was mailed to G. S. R.s every 60 days.
4. Five one-minute talks, suitable for presentation at group meetings, were prepared for use by G. S. R.s
5. Assistance was provided to G. S. R.s in their efforts to raise funds in support of A. A. world services. A special project involving "coin folders" was developed and "promoted" locally.

The result of this approach in Northeast Ohio, Al said, is that the G. S. R.s are more active than ever before because they have a program designed to help them "and which they themselves appreciate and have accepted."

Western New York

Dave K. of Western New York stressed the point that a Delegate cannot "carry the message" entirely by himself and is dependent on G. S. R. cooperation if he hopes to do a good job.

When he first undertook Delegate responsibilities, he was concerned to note that so few district committees were being helped and that very few G. S. R.s even knew each other, Dave said.

At the time of the 1958 Conference in N. Y. C. Dave wrote a note to G. S. R.s in his Area, inviting them to participate in a meeting at which Conference activities would be discussed. At this meeting, he proposed an increase in the number of District meetings and this proposal was accepted.

Ten meetings were held during the past year. In all cases, Dave asked volunteers (G. S. R.s) to help him conduct these sessions at which A. A. services were explained. A special G. S. R. panel was a feature of a large Area meeting. Whenever possible, past Delegates are asked to share the platform at meetings.

Delegates have an important responsibility for assisting G. S. R.s, Dave reminded the Conference. "This activity of course takes time and planning but I can testify that at least one Delegate has found it well worth doing."

Alberta, Canada

A. A. is "incomplete" unless members have an understanding of the Third Legacy of Service, Ken P. of Alberta, Canada, said in during his part of the panel presentation.

Ken paid tribute to the early Conference structure workers in his province for their patience in attempting to carry the service message to A. A.s there in the face of "resistance to change."

Help to Alberta G. S. R.s can be classified under two main categories:

1. Improving communications within the Province Conference structure. This involves holding many small meetings and substantial travel, since the Provincial Committee meets only once a year. There has been a common effort to try to understand and apply Third Legacy principles.
2. Providing an Annual Assembly that would be fruitful to the individual G. S. R. Opportunity is provided for discussion of mutual problems, with special emphasis on creating "a good atmosphere" for the newcomer.

A reasoned, direct approach to members who had not previously appreciated the importance of the Third Legacy proved to be the best strategy for strengthening the A. A. service concept in Alberta, Ken related. Today his concept is accepted "without demure," he said.

As the other speakers had done, Ken emphasized the point that Delegates "should not try to do the whole job by themselves."

Charlie B., General Service Board Trustee and a former Delegate, chaired this session. In his summary, Charlie urged Delegates to make G. S. R.s feel that they are directly responsible for the welfare of their groups and that "the future of A. A. is in their groups' hands."

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS

As is customary at General Service Conferences, Delegates to the 1959 meeting were given ample opportunity to get answers to any and all questions on problems in which they, or their Areas, were interested. Questions could be raised directly from the floor or could be submitted in writing, anonymously, by depositing the queries in a special container, the "Ask-It Basket," on display during most of the Conference.

Following is a brief digest of subjects of general interest raised via the "Ask-It Basket" at the 1959 Conference.

1. Literature (1)

Why is more lower-priced literature not available from A. A. Publishing?

One Delegate commented that in his Area a number of pamphlets are available cheaper than comparable material distributed by G. S. O.

It was pointed out, however, that G. S. O. literature prices also cover the cost of substantial free distribution of pamphlets to prisons, hospitals, new groups, etc. Costs of handling Conference-approved material on a movement-wide basis must be considered; actually, "the profit margin on literature is low."

2. Literature (2)

What has become of the suggestion to publish a pamphlet on the general subject of "old timers?"

The Areas were asked to submit material for the proposed pamphlet. Only three stories were received from the entire U.S. and Canada. The project was therefore dropped due to the patent lack of general interest.

3. Literature (3)

Can A. A. literature be placed in "strategic" areas on a consignment basis, to reduce G. S. O. handling and "promotional" costs?

No. This does not appear feasible. (Many Intergroups, as as a service to their Areas, stock and sell Conference-approved literature.)

4. Literature (4)

In addition to "This Is A. A.," what introductory literature is available for the "brand new" member?

"Is A. A. For You?" and "A. A.—44 Questions and Answers" were cited.

5. Literature (5)

Why doesn't G. S. O. consider reprinting the old "A. A." pamphlet?

Referred to Conference Literature Committee. See report.

6. Literature (6)

Is the decision not to publish a paperback edition of the Big Book a closed issue?

No subject of movement-wide interest is ever a closed issue in the Conference. This particular matter has been explored in detail and the current Conference position was based on special reports at the 1958 Conference.

7. Literature (7)

Can the Conference recommend that certain sums be spent this year for translations of A. A. literature?

The Trustees would, of course, be guided by Conference recommendations. The key problem, however, is the availability of funds to support the translation program already under way.

8. Literature (8)

Many literature items seem to have a different "look" recently. Is some one new in charge of this material?

No.

9. Literature (9)

Could the Big Book be edited and trimmed in size to the point where it could be sold for about \$2.50 without affecting G. S. O. income or Bill's royalties?

The consensus of professional and A. A. opinion appears to be that this would not be feasible.

10. 'Pills'

What does one do with an A. A. member who is technically sober but under the influence of pills?

Discussion disclosed unanimous feeling that, based on experience and observation of A. A. members, alcoholics should not experiment with sedatives or tranquilizers. The role of the sponsor in stressing A. A. experience was emphasized. (Subject will be covered in pamphlet now in preparation.)

11. Pills (2)

Will the A. A. attitude toward Antabuse be covered in the pamphlet now in preparation?

A. A. of course has no "official attitude" favoring or opposing any form of medication. It is planned, however, to cover this subject, as in the past, solely in terms of the experience and observations of A. A. members.

12. 1960 Convention

Will the Convention have authority to make decisions affecting A. A. as a whole?

The Convention has no "legal" authority.

13. Local Service

Should there be a maximum term of office for local service committees? If so, how long?

While this subject is one to be decided on the basis of local autonomy, it appears that in practice the term of service generally coincides with that of the Area Delegate.

14. Local Service (2)

In our State, we have a State Service Committee formed before the Third Legacy came into effect. As a functioning committee, it has been a good one. When the Third Legacy was adopted we formed another committee known as the General Service Committee. We now have the two committees. Is it advisable to combine them into an "All Service Committee?"

Discussion revealed unanimous support for the principle of having one, rather than two, service committees. While it was acknowledged that any attempt to eliminate a "pre-Third Legacy" committee had to be handled tactfully, several Delegates cited examples of success in such matters. It was emphasized that the Third Legacy had to be explained carefully and thoroughly to A. A.s before a successful merger or "substitution" could be achieved.

15. Symbol

Are the words, "Recovery, Unity, Service" a part of the A. A. symbol? (The symbol is occasionally shown without any wording.)

The symbol is actually used in three ways (1) As an identifying decoration, without initials or wording; (2) With initials and the words "General Service Conference," to distinguish Conference-approved literature and other material and (3) With the A. A. initials and the words "Recovery, Unity, Service," as approved by the 1957 Conference, in material prepared by local groups and other A. A. units.

16. Welfare Work

How fine a line can be drawn to distinguish between A. A. assistance and welfare work?

It was agreed that A. A. and welfare work cannot be mixed.

17. Publicity

Why is the Conference not being covered by the New York press?

General Service Conferences have always been regarded as "internal" A. A. affairs.

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS

(Continued)

18. Financial (1)

Why don't foreign members contribute more to G.S.O.?
In most foreign countries, it is extremely difficult to obtain official permission to send money, particularly American dollars, out of the country. Many areas do, however, attempt to support G.S.O.

19. Directory (1)

How is it determined who can receive a copy of the World Directory?

Each Group, Loner and Internationalist receives one copy automatically. Additional copies are available at \$1.50 through Group officers. Requests from agencies outside A.A. are referred to the appropriate Delegate and local service committee before the requests are filled by G.S.O.

20. Directory (2)

Why should an Internationalist member receive a free copy of the Directory?

The influence of Internationalists in spreading word of A.A. and starting new groups around the world is much greater than their membership of 165 would suggest. Also, their contributions in support of A.A. world service are substantially above average.

21. Directory (3)

Will there be a separate directory of Armed Forces Groups?
Yes Preparation of such a listing is under way.

22. Education

Should a Delegate participate in the work of such educational groups as the National Committee on Alcoholism?
Several viewpoints were expressed. One was that certain agencies exploit A.A.'s good name in fund-raising ventures. A second viewpoint was that, so long as a member acts solely as an individual and not as a representative of A.A., there is no reason why he should not contribute hard-earned experience in the field of alcoholism to any agency seeking to assist alcoholics. The sense of the Conference, however, appeared to be that extreme caution was desirable in such activities to avoid involving A.A. in any non-A.A. activity.

23. Conference (1)

What is the average cost per Delegate?
\$240 per Delegate for travel, meals, lodging and other services, based on analysis of 1958 costs.

24. Conference (2)

Can Conference costs be reduced, with a view to making any savings available for Third Legacy services?
Conference costs, which are defrayed from Group funds, as authorized by the Groups, are continually under scrutiny for possible savings. The Trustees have asked the General Service Committee to research all current costs thoroughly before a decision on a site for the 1960 Conference is made. (Conference costs increase as additional Delegates are admitted.)

25. Hospitalization

In our local state hospital, alcoholics are placed in an open ward where drinking occasionally becomes a problem. What experiences have other Delegates had in solving such problems?

Discussion disclosed that experience varies from institution to institution, depending on the discipline enforced by the administration. It was agreed that this is a problem for administrators.

26. Meetings

Is it advisable to invite ministers to closed meetings?
While this was regarded as a problem to be resolved at the group level, it was suggested that an A.A. closed meeting is, by definition, and tradition, limited to alcoholics.

27. Displays

Does G.S.O. have an A.A. display suitable for use at State Conferences?

No, but suggestions and information on the creation of such displays are available.

28. Membership

Why does a Grapevine promotional folder show an estimated A.A. membership (Spring, 1959) of 250,000 while the Directory count totals only 145,830?

Both figures are correct. The smaller figure is actual reported membership. The larger figure is a conservative projection, based in part on findings of the special group census conducted during the Fall of 1958.

29. Coding

Can some method of coding Directory listings be devised in order to discourage use of the list for commercial purposes?

It was agreed that this would not solve the basic problem.

30. Bulletin (1)

The May Bulletin does not publicize the 1960 Convention. Why not?

This issue was devoted primarily to the Conference. Subsequent issues will publicize the Convention heavily.

31. Bulletin (2)

The old-type Bulletin had much more news. Is there any chance of reviving it? How many Delegates think the new Bulletin is a change for the better?

A questionnaire filled out by 1959 Delegates showed that five out of eight approve the new format.

32. Bulletin (3)

Were the groups consulted when the new-type Bulletin was started?

No. The change was considered carefully by the General Service Committee and by various committees of the General Service Board. Members of these committees believed a less "formal" publication would be an improvement. An estimated savings of \$5,000 appears possible with the new format.

33. G. S. O.

Can a simple, comprehensive definition of General Service be prepared?

Referred to the General Service Committee.

34. Tape Recordings

Are tape recordings available for a radio series on A.A.? If so, are they Conference-approved?

G.S.O. has never prepared such material for consideration by the Conference, nor has outside material of this type ever been submitted to the Conference.

The Detroit Central Office has information on the "Mr. Hope" program which was aired in that area. Address: Room 424, McKerchey Building, 2631 Woodward Avenue, Detroit.

35. Television (1)

Is information available on the proposed national television version of the "Mr. Hope" series?

No information available. (See #34 above.)

36. Television (2)

Is G.S.O. actively trying to utilize network television opportunities to "carry the message?"

In line with traditional A.A. public relations policy of attraction, rather than promotion, G.S.O. efforts in this field are limited to letting network television personnel know of our willingness to cooperate in ventures initiated by others. Some appropriate modification of this policy may be made in connection with A.A.'s 25th Anniversary in 1960.

(Continued on Page 23)

BILL'S STATEMENT ON HIS FINANCES

At the 1957 Conference, Bill read to the Delegates the following letter addressed to Mr. Archibald B. Roosevelt, Treasurer of the General Service Board:

Dear Archie:

As many are aware, I have long felt that my personal finances should always be an open book to our membership.

Ever since 1951, when the General Service Conference first met, my book royalties and my expense allowances have been shown in each year's audit. This practice will of course be continued.

This year, however, I would like to make a full accounting for all monies received by me from 1938, when the Alcoholic Foundation was created, to 1955 when, at St. Louis, the Conference and its General Service Board assumed final responsibility for A.A.'s world affairs.

This seventeen-year audit has been prepared by Mr. Wilbur Smith, our CPA, and is here enclosed. Saving the small amounts I received as a result of Mr. Rockefeller's 1940 dinner, it can be seen that my whole income over those years has derived only from A.A. Publishing activities. My other services to the Headquarters were all volunteer.

I earnestly recommend that this detailed accounting be always shown to every Conference Delegate on request; and further that a copy of this audit be placed on permanent file at the New York Headquarters where, on request, it can be read by any visiting A.A. member.

Ever yours,

Bill

(Signed in full)

WGW/nw

P.S. I hope that the Conference sees fit to publish this letter each year in its annual report.

37. Consultants

Why do the Certified Public Accountant and the Literature Consultant attend the Conference? Do they have the right to vote?

The C.P.A. is available to answer all questions pertaining to G.S.O. finances. The Literature Consultant attends in order to be able to prepare various Conference reports to the movement. Neither person is a member of the Conference. Neither can vote.

38. Service Principles

Why not condense a description of the Third Legacy and of A.A. General Service aims into simplified and specific categories, twelve in number, in such a way that they can become weekly discussion topics in the groups, as the Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions now are?

Bill told the Delegates that he is working on a series of essays dealing with A.A. principles of service. No publication date has yet been set; in fact, many experienced A.A.s will be consulted before the essays reach final manuscript form.

39. G. S. O.

What facilities does A.A. have for blind people?

While G.S.O. does not prepare material specifically for blind people, an attempt is made to keep informed on materials available elsewhere.

40. Discussion Topics

Several discussion topics were presented to the Delegates for consideration when they reached the 1959 Conference.

Why were these matters not referred to the Areas for discussion prior to the Conference? Why can't such matters be referred to the Areas prior to the Conference in the future?

The topics, all covered in other sections of this report, required the presentation of background information which could not be transmitted to the Areas adequately by mail. It would be a disservice to both Groups and Delegates to expect them to consider such matters in their proper perspective before they were presented in detail to the Conference.

(No topic is ever presented to a Conference on the premise that a decision has to be made immediately. If Delegates do not feel their Areas are adequately informed on a particular matter, it is their right and privilege, if they so desire, to refer any topic back to the Areas prior to taking action at a later Conference.)

AREA REQUEST

The Southern California Area, through its Delegate, asked the Conference to consider its request that the General Service Board should in the future always include an A.A. Trustee from West of the Rocky Mountains. During discussion, it was pointed out that alcoholic Trustees traditionally do not represent an Area, but A.A. as a whole. A motion was made and seconded to place on the 1960 Conference agenda the subject of changing the present method of selecting A.A. Trustees. The motion was defeated overwhelmingly by a voice vote.

COMBINED BALANCE SHEET

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc. Alcoholics Anonymous Publishing, Inc.
The Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1958 and 1957

	DECEMBER 31, 1958					DECEMBER 31, 1957				
	GENERAL SERVICE BOARD GENERAL	OFFICE	A.A. PUBLISHING	A.A. GRAPEVINE	COMBINED TOTAL	GENERAL SERVICE BOARD GENERAL	OFFICE	A.A. PUBLISHING	A.A. GRAPEVINE	COMBINED TOTAL
WHAT WE OWNED:										
Cash, Except Reserve Fund	\$ 42,269	\$23,809	\$ 36,788	\$ 9,633	\$112,499	\$ 27,650	\$ 15,380	\$ 12,603	\$12,412	\$68,045
Accounts Receivable	1,235		4,050	3,319	8,604			5,328	3,139	8,467
Inventories			56,800		56,800			66,300		66,300
Advance Royalties			1,001		1,001			2,186		2,186
Other Prepaid Expenses	853		3,647	6,790	11,290	1,221	64	2,187	7,840	11,312
Furniture and Equipment (net)			1	3,804	3,805			1	4,348	4,349
RESERVE FUND—Cash and Securities at Cost	170,105		2,196		172,301	168,177		1,254		169,431
Inter-Company Accounts:										
Advances	13,766	6,347	18,251		Note C	12,824	14,918	18,740		Note C
Less: Reserve for Loss	(11,570)				Note B	(11,570)				Note B
Investments	501				Note D	501				Note D
TOTAL ASSETS	<u>217,159</u>	<u>30,156</u>	<u>122,734</u>	<u>23,546</u>	<u>366,300</u>	<u>198,803</u>	<u>30,362</u>	<u>108,599</u>	<u>27,739</u>	<u>330,090</u>
DEDUCT WHAT WE OWED										
Accounts and Accruals Payable	717		9,049	4,936	14,702	24		5,745	5,958	11,727
Unearned Subscription Income				47,003	47,003				47,100	47,100
Inter-Company Accounts:										
Advances	6,347	18,251	2,196	11,570	Note C	14,925	18,457	1,254	11,845	Note C
Capital Stock			500	1	Note D			500	1	Note D
TOTAL LIABILITIES	<u>7,064</u>	<u>18,251</u>	<u>11,745</u>	<u>63,510</u>	<u>61,705</u>	<u>14,949</u>	<u>18,457</u>	<u>7,499</u>	<u>64,904</u>	<u>58,827</u>
NET WORTH	<u>210,095</u>	<u>11,905</u>	<u>110,989</u>	<u>(39,964)</u>	<u>304,595</u>	<u>183,854</u>	<u>11,905</u>	<u>101,100</u>	<u>(37,165)</u>	<u>271,263</u>
NET WORTH COMPRISED OF:										
Accumulated Income:										
Balance, Jan. 1, less Reserve Fund	\$ 29,341	\$11,905	\$101,100	(\$37,165)	\$105,181	\$ 15,089	\$ 16,905	\$ 83,904	(\$24,006)	\$91,891
Income (Expense) for Period—Exhibit A	(15,160)	(6,347)	39,889	(2,799)	15,583	(15,748)	(14,918)	\$42,196	(13,159)	(1,629)
Inter-Company Transfers:										
Adjustments of Advances—Note B					11,570	5,000	(5,000)			11,570
Dividends and Other	23,653	6,347	(30,000)			25,000	14,918	(25,000)		14,918
RESERVE FUND—Note A	172,260				172,260	154,513				154,513
NET WORTH — as above	<u>210,095</u>	<u>11,905</u>	<u>110,989</u>	<u>(39,964)</u>	<u>304,595</u>	<u>183,854</u>	<u>11,905</u>	<u>101,100</u>	<u>(37,165)</u>	<u>271,263</u>
NOTE A — RESERVE FUND	YEAR 1958		YEAR 1957							
Balance, January 1	\$154,513		\$147,564							
Book Discounts Donated	14,324		17,079							
Investment Income	3,423		4,788							
			169,431							
Transferred to Group Fund			14,918							
Balance, December 31	<u>172,260</u>		<u>154,513</u>							

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NOTE B — A reserve of \$11,570, provided in 1956 for possible loss on advances to The A. A. Grapevine, Inc., is restored to NET WORTH in consolidation. Payment of \$5,000 was made in 1957 by the Group Fund to the General Fund on account of advances by the latter Fund to make up deficits in Group Contributions in 1949 and 1950. It is presently intended that any excess of contributions received over Office and Conferences expenses will be transferred to the Reserve Fund in payment of advances to make up deficits in contributions of \$6,347 in 1958, \$14,918 in 1957 and \$15,000 in prior years.

NOTES C and D — Elimination of inter-company items.

COMBINED INCOME STATEMENT

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc. Alcoholics Anonymous Publishing, Inc.
The Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

DECEMBER 31, 1958 and 1957

	YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1958					YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1957				
	GENERAL SERVICE BOARD GENERAL	OFFICE	A.A. PUBLISHING	A.A. GRAPEVINE	TOTAL	GENERAL SERVICE BOARD GENERAL	OFFICE	A.A. PUBLISHING	A.A. GRAPEVINE	TOTAL
WE RECEIVED FROM:										
Book Sales		NUMBER					NUMBER			
Alcoholics Anonymous		20,463	\$ 70,590		\$ 70,590		21,125	\$ 72,854		\$ 72,854
12 Steps and 12 Traditions		7,183	15,959		15,959		7,707	17,212		17,212
A. A. Comes of Age		<u>6,564</u>	19,382		19,382		<u>11,352</u>	34,212		34,212
Pamphlets and Other Sales			85,595		85,595			74,270		74,270
Grapevine Sales and Subscriptions				\$134,634	134,634				\$124,341	124,341
Total Sales					326,160					322,889
Contributions	\$ 2,451	\$188,348			190,799	\$169,042				169,042
TOTAL INCOME	<u>2,451</u>	<u>188,348</u>	<u>191,526</u>	<u>134,634</u>	<u>516,959</u>	<u>169,042</u>		<u>198,548</u>	<u>124,341</u>	<u>491,931</u>
WE SPENT FOR:										
Cost of Products Sold			59,508	51,067	110,575			54,182	49,349	103,531
Royalties on Books			20,703		20,703			24,213		24,213
Shipping and Mailing			15,235	14,550	29,785			13,724	16,036	29,760
Salaries	900	98,606	30,919	49,367	179,792		94,565	30,154	46,281	171,000
Public Relations and Writers			7,500		7,500			6,000		6,000
Legal and Accounting	2,480		2,700	2,100	7,280	\$ 3,471		3,026	2,775	9,272
Honorarium	2,000				2,000	2,000				2,000
Rent		14,796	5,772	7,204	27,772		14,853	5,562	3,928	24,343
Printing	1,063	28,931			29,994	2,102	24,865			26,967
Stationery and Office Supplies		6,039		1,547	7,586		6,302		2,955	9,257
Telephone and Telegraph		3,263		992	4,255		2,947		817	3,764
New Equipment or Depreciation		4,303	576	804	5,683		4,909	340	940	6,189
Other Office Expenses	49	9,756	968	3,754	14,527	64	6,189	983	2,945	10,181
Insurance	367	3,471		848	4,686	374	3,269		982	4,625
Taxes		3,645	591	1,660	5,896		4,076	500	1,653	6,229
Board, Committee, Staff Meetings	5,082	1,571		670	7,323	5,327	1,419		648	7,394
Promotion				2,622	2,622			883	7,310	8,193
Writing and Research			7,165		7,165			12,870		12,870
Bedford Hills Expense	3,515				3,515			3,915		3,915
General Service Conference		20,314		248	20,562		20,566		881	21,447
Public Information Committee	1,597				1,597	832				832
Television Programs	558				558	1,578				1,578
TOTAL COSTS & EXPENSES	<u>17,611</u>	<u>194,695</u>	<u>151,637</u>	<u>137,433</u>	<u>501,376</u>	<u>15,748</u>	<u>183,960</u>	<u>156,352</u>	<u>137,500</u>	<u>493,560</u>
EXCESS OF INCOME (Expense)—EXHIBIT B	<u>(15,160)</u>	<u>(6,347)</u>	<u>39,889</u>	<u>(2,799)</u>	<u>15,583</u>	<u>(15,748)</u>	<u>(14,918)</u>	<u>42,196</u>	<u>(13,159)</u>	<u>(1,629)</u>
Dividend Rec'd A.A. Pub., Inc.	\$ 30,000					\$ 25,000				
Transfers	(6,347)	\$ 6,347					\$ 14,918 (From Reserve Fund)			
NET INCOME AFTER TRANSFERS	<u>8,593</u>	<u>None</u>				<u>9,252</u>	<u>None</u>			

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See Note A on Exhibit B for Changes in RESERVE FUND

1958 GROUP CONTRIBUTIONS TO GENERAL SERVICE OFFICE FUND

(United States Groups)

(Canadian Groups)

	# of Gps. Reported	# of Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib's. Per Capita		# of Gps. Reported	# of Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib's. Per Capita
Alabama	36	25	69%	\$ 1,447.00	1,069	\$1.35	Alberta	72	45	63%	\$ 1,503.18	808	\$1.86
Alaska	15	11	73%	438.00	164	2.67	Atlantic Provinces						
Arizona	42	33	79%	1,286.16	650	1.98	New Brunswick	22	10	45%	370.18	386	.96
Arkansas	52	32	62%	1,034.00	779	1.33	Newfoundland	7	6	86%	91.00	113	.81
California	719	474	66%	26,851.31	15,255	1.76	Nova Scotia	39	29	74%	936.08	547	1.71
Colorado	58	49	84%	2,226.00	1,145	1.94	Prince Edward Isle	7	4	57%	159.73	156	1.02
Connecticut	74	54	73%	2,617.10	1,535	1.70	British Columbia	128	76	59%	3,684.92	1,857	1.98
Delaware	14	11	79%	563.00	251	2.24	Manitoba	30	21	70%	1,462.17	724	2.02
District of Columbia	21	16	76%	900.22	495	1.82	Ontario	270	200	74%	9,051.52	3,930	2.30
Florida	169	118	70%	5,804.80	3,040	1.91	Quebec	141	65	46%	1,716.40	1,963	.87
Georgia	57	35	61%	1,558.50	920	1.69	Saskatchewan	57	46	81%	1,484.49	648	2.29
Idaho	24	19	79%	766.00	351	2.18	Yukon Territory	1	1	100%	47.36	30	1.58
Illinois	454	401	88%	4,769.51	6,623	.72	Northwest Territories	1	1	100%	37.74	19	1.99
Indiana	134	91	68%	3,218.82	1,960	1.64	Total for Canada	775	504	65%	\$ 20,544.77	11,181	\$1.84
Iowa	70	47	67%	2,290.30	1,496	1.53	Total U.S.A. & Canada	6,218	4,315	69%	\$184,388.92	110,039	\$1.68
Kansas	72	59	82%	2,537.07	1,437	1.77	FOREIGN	915			2,455.34	14,306	
Kentucky	58	42	72%	2,256.33	863	2.61	LONE MEMBERS				* *	* *	
Louisiana	62	40	65%	1,557.40	1,090	1.43	INTERNATIONALISTS				539.63	165	
Maine	39	31	79%	783.00	517	1.51	HOSPITAL GROUPS	285			524.60	7,077	
Maryland	82	50	61%	1,878.50	1,510	1.24	PRISON GROUPS	347			292.31	14,243	
Massachusetts	155	100	65%	4,817.00	2,939	1.64	GRAND TOTAL	7,765			\$188,200.80	145,830	
Michigan	266	171	64%	8,123.58	4,860	1.67							
Minnesota	215	184	86%	4,973.56	3,877	1.28							
Mississippi	30	25	83%	1,139.50	578	1.97							
Missouri	103	91	88%	3,367.35	2,151	1.57							
Montana	36	24	67%	734.25	407	1.80							
Nebraska	40	30	75%	982.00	494	1.99							
Nevada	23	15	65%	648.50	373	1.74							
New Hampshire	18	9	50%	344.00	277	1.24							
New Jersey	164	94	57%	4,924.56	2,485	1.98							
New Mexico	29	19	66%	669.25	478	1.40							
New York	363	240	66%	13,851.05	7,473	1.85							
North Carolina	120	73	61%	3,821.66	2,173	1.76							
North Dakota	38	29	76%	859.00	469	1.83							
Ohio	373	204	55%	9,553.44	7,876	1.21							
Oklahoma	70	56	80%	3,843.07	1,259	3.05							
Oregon	68	46	68%	1,856.86	885	2.10							
Pennsylvania	223	156	70%	6,538.28	3,427	1.91							
Rhode Island	18	11	61%	328.00	198	1.66							
South Carolina	64	44	69%	1,467.50	1,029	1.43							
South Dakota	39	26	67%	1,049.50	646	1.62							
Tennessee	46	28	61%	1,532.68	868	1.77							
Texas	250	168	67%	9,995.53	5,357	1.87							
Utah	42	24	57%	783.00	752	1.04							
Vermont	21	18	86%	696.00	319	2.18							
Virginia	83	56	67%	3,332.70	1,826	1.83							
Washington	103	79	77%	3,442.91	1,620	2.13							
West Virginia	43	32	74%	971.00	583	1.67							
Wisconsin	131	109	83%	3,870.90	1,811	2.14							
Wyoming	17	12	71%	544.50	218	2.50							
Total for U. S. A.	5,443	3,811	70%	\$163,844.15	98,858	\$1.66							

* * Contributions and membership of Lone Members included in State, Province and Foreign totals.

\$

PURPOSES AND RESTRICTIONS OF GENERAL SERVICE BOARD FUNDS

THE RESERVE FUND was established in 1954 by transfer from the General Fund of cash then on deposit in savings accounts, for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve. Its use must be authorized by the Board of Trustees, on recommendation of the Finance and Budgetary Committee.

The GROUP CONTRIBUTION FUND, established in 1941, receives contributions from A. A. Groups and members which may be used solely for the expenses of the General Service Office and the costs of the General Service Conference.

The GENERAL FUND is comprised of those assets not included in either of the above Funds and may be used for any of the purposes for which the General Service Board of A. A., Inc. was incorporated.

POLICY

REPORT OF THE COMMITTEE ON POLICY

The Committee recommends that:

1. \$3.00 per member replace the \$2.00 suggested as annual contribution to G. S. O.
2. Meeting nights be listed in 1960 Directory.
3. *The Exchange Bulletin* continue in its present format for the next year.
4. Material for new Loners be compiled from current Loner questionnaires.
5. Traditional A. A. policy of declining bequests in any form, from A. A.'s or non-A. A.'s, be reaffirmed, and that all Delegates receive a copy of current letter used in declining such bequests.
6. In regard to A. A. misuse of Directory, the attention of groups again be directed to purpose, as listed on inside cover of Directory. That this be used as a guide and not rule, as it is not intended to interfere with free communication among A. A.'s in sharing experiences and activities. That non-A. A. misuse be handled as in the past.
7. Delegates receive a thumb-nail sketch of fifteen current Trustees of General Service Board for communicating information to their areas.
8. Consideration and study be made by all Delegates during the coming year on the possibility of all GSO group mailings going to GSRs and that this subject be placed on the 1960 Agenda as a discussion subject.

Report adopted unanimously.

LITERATURE

REPORT OF THE LITERATURE COMMITTEE

The Committee considered the recommendation of the General Service Board Literature Committee and:

1. Approved a new pamphlet for inmate alcoholics as outlined in the memorandum from GSO literature consultant.
2. Approved the preparation of a pamphlet to inform clergymen of A. A.'s sole purpose and how they can help the alcoholic find sobriety in A. A.
3. Approved the suggestion that the Delegates to the 1960 Conference be surveyed for information about industrial and business programs in their areas, and suggested that information be obtained from outside sources as well, so that GSO material can be brought up-to-date and the pamphlet, "The Alcohol Employee," can be revised.

The Committee also considered the request that the old "A. A." pamphlet, now out of print, be again published by A. A. Publishing, Inc. Since there have been very limited requests for this pamphlet, which went out of print a number of years ago, the Committee feels that the demand is not sufficient to justify republishing it at the present time.

As previously reported in the Conference, the revised "Sedatives" pamphlet will be ready for distribution as soon as approved by the joint Literature Committees.

Considered the recommendation of the Study Committee on Relations with Outside Agencies for a brief folder on *cooperation* but *not affiliation* with outside agencies, and suggested that this be handled as a *Grapevine* article and reprinted and made available to A. A. members and outside agencies by GSO.

Report adopted unanimously.

ADMISSIONS

REPORT OF THE COMMITTEE ON ADMISSIONS

No requests for additional representation were presented to this Committee.

The Committee wishes to reaffirm the recommendation of the 1958 Admissions Committee that all future Committees earnestly study the Admissions Committee Fact File, always being cognizant of the fact that the Conference, by virtue of an increased number of Delegates, is in danger of becoming unwieldy and unfair to all A. A. members.

Report adopted unanimously.

Standing Committees of the 1959 Conference

AGENDA

Pearl Nikkinen, North Minnesota
Charles Highly, Puerto Rico
*Cec Corrigan, Sask., Canada
Russell Moffit, Eastern Ontario
Fr. George Eagleton, Nevada
Al Smith, Washington
(Lyb S.—Sec.)

ADMISSIONS TO CONFERENCE

Glenn Walters, Idaho
Earle O'Hagan, South New Jersey
*Jean Norris, Mississippi
William Suffern, Downstate, Illinois
Charles Small, Virginia
George English, Oklahoma
(Eve M.—Sec.)

CONFERENCE REPORT AND CHARTER

*N. D. (Lib) Libby, Oregon
Ben Edgerton, San Diego, California
Phil Carter, Mohawk-Hudson, New York
S. A. Fishburn, N. E. Texas
Jim Shands, North Florida
Ham Kupper, S. E. New York
(Eve M.—Sec.)

FINANCE

*Ralph Seward, N. W. Ohio & S. E. Mich.
Louis Mulherin, Georgia
Myles Thomas, Montana
Mildred Anderson, Colorado
Emerson Laughland, Central New York
Lloyd Ramer, Arkansas
(Anita R.—Sec.)

GRAPEVINE

Duane Rolofson, No. Interior Co., Calif.
John L. Medek, Downstate, Illinois
Dr. V. D. Brown, Kansas
Tom Brannagan, Northern New Jersey
John Dozier, S. E. Texas
*Ralph Black, Alabama
(Helen W.—Sec.)

LITERATURE

Joe Lucas, New Mexico
John Finton, Western, Mass.
*Rufus W. Smith, Tennessee
Harold Shurson, Southern Minnesota
Walter King, Los Angeles, Calif.
Eugene Munger, Eastern Missouri
(Lyb S.—Sec.)

POLICY

Dennis Wilmoth, S. W. Texas
Clarence Martin, Maryland
*Tom Zenor, South Dakota
Stanton Funk, Western Pa.
Cecil Cragun, Utah
Charles Gray, Western Missouri
(Hazel R.—Sec.)

TRUSTEES

Ladd Skinner, South & Southwest, Ohio
Sam Vosburgh, Nebraska
*William Wallace, Kentucky
Tom Judge, No. Coastal, Calif.
James Galligan, Chicago, Illinois
Pat O'Brien, Louisiana
(Ann M.—Sec.)

*Chairman

AGENDA

REPORT OF THE AGENDA COMMITTEE

The Committee reviewed the 1959 Agenda, and recommends that:

1. The G.S.O. Staff reports be given more time to provide more human interest anecdotes, and that they be scheduled as the first order of business, one after the other, and not with other reports. Ten minutes is suggested for each report.
2. The selection of Conference Committees again be the second order of business in the opening morning session.
3. The General Service Board report and those of its Committees be limited to five minutes each and scheduled with other business for the Second Conference Session in the afternoon, or in later sessions if desirable.
4. G.S.O. briefing session for new Delegates prior to the opening of Conference deliberations, be continued.
5. Delegates speaking from the floor limit themselves to 3 minutes.
6. The Puerto Rican flag be displayed with the American and Canadian flags at future Conferences.

The Committee agreed to review proposals during the coming year, with appropriate advice to G.S.O.

Expressed gratitude to Eve Marsh and Hank Grieme for their efforts on behalf of the 1959 Conference.

Report adopted unanimously.

SPECIAL

REPORT OF THE STUDY COMMITTEE ON RELATIONS WITH OUTSIDE AGENCIES

The Committee recognizes the need for clarifying the relationship of the A.A. movement with outside alcoholic agencies and for providing material which will assist Delegates in the solution of problems which may arise in such relationships.

The Committee recommends to the Conference that it take these specific actions:

1. Provide a Conference resolution reaffirming the principles involved in such relationships.
2. Approve the preparation of an Information File on the subject which will be made available to Delegates and others interested.
3. Approve the preparation of a pamphlet or reprint to be offered to the membership through the publishing company.

The Committee suggests that the resolution be worded as follows:

A RESOLUTION OF THE 1959 GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE

Be it hereby resolved that:

It is the sense of the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous that its membership is deeply appreciative of the spirit and assistance manifested by various agencies in dealing with the problem of alcoholism,

and it is further the sense of this Conference that its membership is willing and anxious to cooperate in all efforts to assist the suffering alcoholic short of affiliation with outside agencies in any way,

and it is further the sense of this Conference that although our Fellowship does not operate or finance facilities of the nature provided by national, state and local agencies and committees, it is deemed entirely proper that some of its members, acting solely as citizens, may take position with these agencies or commissions, but in no way acting or speaking as representatives of Alcoholics Anonymous.

The Committee suggests that the Information File contain:

1. A statement of the A.A. principles involved and a review of the critical areas which A.A. individuals and groups should recognize in their relationships with outside agencies.
2. Press releases and radio and TV scripts clarifying A.A.'s proper relationship.

Report adopted unanimously.

Special Committees of the 1959 Conference

1960 CONVENTION

Wes Parrish, South Florida (Panel 9)
Tom Anderson, South Jersey (Panel 7)
Bill Henderson, Northwest Texas (Panel 7)
Bill Wallace, Kentucky (Panel 8)
Carl Simon, Wisconsin (Panel 8)
Ian MacLeod, Atlantic Provinces (Panel 8)
Al Lackey, N.E. Ohio (Panel 9)
Robert Engle, District of Columbia (Panel 9)
Bill Short, B.C., Canada (Panel 9)
Hank G.—Chairman
Herb Morse—Public Relations Chairman
Paul Gardner, No. Coastal Co., Calif. (Panel 7)
Ben Edgerton, San Diego (Panel 8)
Duane Rolofson, No. Interior Co., Calif. (Panel 8)
Tom Judge, No. Coastal Co. (Panel 9)
Art Brooks, S. Coastal Co. (Panel 8)
Walter King, Los Angeles (Panel 9)
Glenn Christianson, Los Angeles—Co-Chairman (P. 7)
Stan Wilsey, San Francisco—Co-Chairman (Panel 5)
Hazel Rice—Secretary

STUDY COMMITTEE

On Relations With Outside Agencies

Herbert A. Morse—Chairman
Dr. John L. Norris
Hal Shurson, Southern Minnesota
Pat O'Brien, Louisiana
Cecil Cragun, Utah
Walter King, Los Angeles, California
George Knight, Maine
Fr. George Eagleton, Nevada
John Davis, Arizona
Gus Marschke, North Dakota
Dave Kennedy, Western New York
(Beth K., Sec.)

GRAPEVINE

REPORT OF THE CONFERENCE COMMITTEE ON THE GRAPEVINE

After review of the Delegates' discussion at the Conference Grapevine session the Committee recommends:

1. That the emphasis in all circulation-building efforts be directed toward stressing an increased awareness of A.A. Grapevine as a vital service tool for the use of individuals and groups.
2. That the continuity of this "awareness" of the Grapevine be insured by initiating a plan at the State and Area level, whereby a permanent area Grapevine representative be appointed to work independently of the General Service representative, stressing the Grapevine as a special tool of communication within A.A.
3. That all promotion suggestions made by the Delegates in the Conference Grapevine session be incorporated into a special report to be sent to all Delegates, Committeemen and Area Representatives as additional suggestions of useful ways of spreading the A.A. Grapevine message.
4. That State and Area Conferences be encouraged to have a local Grapevine representative in attendance at Conferences or Conventions to encourage subscriptions by individuals and groups.
5. That the Grapevine office prepare, as soon as possible, material to be made available for these Conference representatives with a suggested method of displaying them at the meetings.

Report adopted unanimously.

FINANCE

REPORT OF CONFERENCE COMMITTEE ON FINANCE

The Committee recognizes that:

1. Every group and every member must know why we have a General Service Office and understand the part they play in worldwide Twelfth Step work.
2. Individual recovery was accomplished by faith, hard work and enthusiasm. It seems feasible these qualities will also work in perpetuating A. A. world services.
3. It will be helpful to some Delegates to receive information during the year on contributions made by groups in their areas.

The Committee makes the following suggestions:

1. That the pilot plan for individual contributions continue to be explored.
2. That each Delegate choose a Group Fund Plan he believes is most likely to be successful in his area.

The following suggestions have been made by various Delegates:

- a. Birthday Plan
 - b. Monthly budgeted contributions
 - c. Pint-a-Month donations
 - d. Coin Folders
 - e. Card or receipt for individual members
 - f. Pass empty whiskey bottle at each meeting earmarked for worldwide Twelfth Step work.
 - g. Tin can or piggy bank
 - h. Five cents per member present at each meeting taken out of collection. (More detailed information available on request.)
3. That Delegates send list of their groups to G. S. O. quarterly and have contributions filled in when it will be helpful.
 4. New pamphlet "Inside A. A." be utilized in informing our membership on "Getting Things Done in A. A. on a Worldwide Basis".
 - 5.. That the over-all problem of providing sufficient funds be approached with an attitude of optimism.

Report adopted unanimously.

REPORT AND CHARTER

REPORT OF THE COMMITTEE ON THE CONFERENCE REPORT AND CHARTER

The Committee recommends that the first draft of the 1959 Conference Report be referred to the members of this Committee for suggestions and corrections as soon as it is completed.

They will return their corrected drafts within a week in order not to delay the mailing of the Final Conference Report to all Conference members.

Report adopted unanimously.

AREA DELEGATES

REPORT OF THE "AREA DELEGATES ONLY" MEETING

Actions taken and matters discussed at the 1959 "Area Delegates Only" meeting included the following:

1. The 1959 "Hospitality Committee" was designated, comprising the following Delegates: Chairman, Larry Wantland (Central & SE Ohio); Tom Judge (N. Coastal Countries, California); Robert Macpherson (Connecticut); James Galligan (Chicago, Illinois); William Suffern (Downstate Illinois); Mildred Anderson (Colorado).
2. Upon motion duly made and seconded, the Chairman of the 1960 "Area Delegates Only" Meeting was selected by drawing a name from a hat. The name of James Galligan of Chicago, Illinois, was drawn.
3. The Delegates recorded their thanks to Eve Marsh for the outstanding job she has done as Conference Secretary over the last year
4. The Reports of General Service Office as they appear in the Delegates' portfolio were approved.
5. There was discussion on the subject of contributions to General Service Office. Several Delegates cited ways and means money is collected in their Areas. A motion to rescind the action taken by the Delegates at an earlier session in approving fund appeals based on \$3.00 per member per year, failed of passage.
6. A motion that the words "there are no dues or fees" be deleted from the "official" definition of A. A. failed of passage.
7. Upon motion duly made and seconded, the Delegates reaffirmed the traditional A. A. practice of declining bequests in any form, from members or non-members. A request was made that Delegates be permitted to see the standard letter declining bequests.
8. A suggestion was made that consideration be given to a continuing census of membership.
9. It was suggested that whenever possible, Delegates be informed prior to their arrival at a Conference, of the qualifications of all nominees for Class B Trusteeship.

Report adopted unanimously.

TRUSTEES

REPORT OF THE COMMITTEE ON TRUSTEES

The Conference Committee on Trustees recommends that the Report of the Nominating Committee of the General Service Board be adopted. (See page 12.)

Report adopted unanimously.

1959 CONFERENCE AREA DELEGATES

STATE	PANEL	STATE	PANEL
ALABAMA	(9) <i>Black, Ralph</i> , Box 1586, Montgomery	MICHIGAN	(9) Central — <i>Davidson, George</i> , 1436 Birney, Saginaw
ALASKA	(8) <i>Ritter, Frances</i> , 924 "A" Street, Juneau		(9) Eastern — <i>Love, Jack</i> , 2370 Harvard Rd., Berkley
ARIZONA	(8) <i>Davis, John</i> , 4036 E. Fairmont, Phoenix		(8) Western — <i>Walker, George</i> , 1015 N. Park St., Kalamazoo
ARKANSAS	(9) <i>Ramer, Loyd</i> , 5 Berkshire Drive, Little Rock		(8) Northern — <i>Nikkinen, Pearl</i> , 1124 E. Washington St., Ely
CALIFORNIA	(9) Southern — <i>King, Walter</i> , 5303 S. St. Andrew Pl., Los Angeles 62	MINNESOTA	(9) Southern — <i>Shurson, Harold</i> , 4701 3rd Ave. S., Minneapolis
	(9) N. Coastal <i>Judge, Tom</i> , c/o San Francisco Inter-County Fellowship, 166 Geary St., San Francisco	MISSISSIPPI	(8) <i>Norris, Mr. Jean</i> , Box 283, Indianola
	(8) N. Interior — <i>Rolofson, Duane</i> , 1404 Vernon Ave., Modesto	MISSOURI	(9) Eastern — <i>Munger, Eugene</i> , 426 Title Guaranty Bldg., 706 Chestnut St., St. Louis 1
	(8) San Diego — <i>Edgerton, Ben</i> , 612 East 8th St., National City		(9) Western — <i>Gray, Charles</i> , 3040 E. 9th, Joplin
	(8) S. Coastal — <i>Brooks, Art</i> , 1159B E. 10th St., Long Beach	MONTANA	(8) <i>Thomas, Myles</i> , Box 235, Helena
COLORADO	(9) <i>Anderson, Mildred</i> , 1225 N. Cedar St., Colorado Springs	NEBRASKA	(8) <i>Vosburgh, H. M.</i> , Box 500 Kearney
CONNECTICUT	(9) <i>Macpherson, Robert</i> , 66 Ashley St., Hartford	NEVADA	(9) <i>Eagleton, Rev. Fr. George</i> , Box 93, Winnemucca
DELAWARE	(8) <i>Mullin, MacSumner</i> , 1406 Philadelphia Pike, Wilmington	NEW HAMPSHIRE	(8) <i>Ratcliffe, William</i> , 95 Winter St., Rochester
DISTRICT OF COL.	(9) <i>Engle, Robert</i> , 1315 Holly St., N. W., Washington, D. C.	NEW JERSEY	(9) Northern — <i>Brannagan, Thomas</i> , 294 Hayes Dr., Saddle Brook, Rochelle Park
FLORIDA	(9) Northern — <i>Shands, Jim</i> , 1025 N. W. 14th Ave., Gainesville		(8) Southern — <i>O'Hagan, Earl</i> , 154 Tettemer Ave., Trenton 10
	(9) Southern — <i>Parrish, Wesley</i> , Box 246, Pompano Beach	NEW MEXICO	(8) <i>Lucas, Joe</i> , 701 S. Michigan, Roswell
GEORGIA	(8) <i>Mulherin, Louis</i> , 1211 Peachtree Road, Augusta	NEW YORK	(9) Central — <i>Laughland, Emerson</i> , 531 Hycliff Dr. N., Watertown
IDAHO	(8) <i>Walters, Glenn</i> , Box 535, Sugar City		(8) Mohawk-Hudson — <i>Carter, Phil</i> , 35 Park St., Williamstown, Mass.
ILLINOIS	(9) Chicago — <i>Galligan, James</i> , 2246 East 73rd Street, Chicago		(9) Southeastern — <i>Kupper, Ham</i> , 2511 New Kirk Ave., Brooklyn
	(9) Downstate — <i>Suffern, William H.</i> , 3915 Park Lane, Decatur		(8) Western — <i>Kennedy, David</i> , 458 Best St., Buffalo
	(8) Downstate — <i>Medek, John</i> , RFD 2, Box 251, Forest Hills, Lockport	NORTH CAROLINA	(9) <i>Coleman, Sloan</i> , 333 Pearson Dr., Asheville
INDIANA	(9) <i>Robinson, A. O.</i> , 910 Salamonie Ave., Huntington	NORTH DAKOTA	(8) <i>Marschke, Gus</i> , 1112 2nd Ave. N., Fargo
IOWA	(9) <i>Link, Al</i> , 2220 Evergreen Dr., Dubuque	OHIO	(9) Central & S. Eastern — <i>Wantland, Larry</i> , 7 E. Sugar St., Mt. Vernon
KANSAS	(8) <i>Brown, Dr. V. D.</i> , 1409 E. Kellogg, Wichita		(9) Northeastern — <i>Lackey, Al</i> , 343 Van St., Barborton
KENTUCKY	(8) <i>Wallace, William</i> , 13 Lelia St., Jeffersonville, Indiana		(8) N. W. Ohio & S. E. Michigan — <i>Seward, Ralph</i> , Manitou Beach, Michigan
LOUISIANA	(9) <i>O'Brien, Pat</i> , 2140 Terrace Ave., Baton Rouge		(8) South & S. Western — <i>Skinner, Ladd</i> , 1111 Delta Ave., Cincinnati
MAINE	(8) <i>Knight, George</i> , Alcoholism Counseling Center, 154 State St., Presque Isle	OKLAHOMA	(9) <i>English, George</i> , 1423 West Britton Rd., Oklahoma City 14
MARYLAND	(8) <i>Martin, Clarence</i> , 2105 So. Governor Ritchie Hwy., Glen Burnie	OREGON	(8) <i>Libby, Norval</i> , 1820 I St., Springfield
MASSACHUSETTS	(9) Eastern — <i>Noone, John</i> , 22 Holyoke Road, West Somerville	PENNSYLVANIA	(9) Eastern — <i>Hales, Edward</i> , Waterloo Rd., & Beaumont Dr., Devon
	(8) Western — <i>Finton, John</i> , 123 Essex St., Springfield	RHODE ISLAND	(9) Western — <i>Funk, Stanton</i> , 325 E. Wheeling St., Washington
			(8) <i>Hynson, Larry</i> , 64 Gibson Rd., Bristol

1959 CONFERENCE AREA DELEGATES

STATE	PANEL	STATE	PANEL
SOUTH CAROLINA	(8) <i>Ingle, Viv</i> , c/o P. O. Box 477, Moncks Corner		(9) Southern— <i>Vallee, Richard</i> , 4722 N. Hollywood Ave., Milwaukee 17
SOUTH DAKOTA	(8) <i>Zenor, Thomas</i> , 2918 Dundee St., Rapid City	WYOMING	(8) <i>Butler, Cooley</i> , Pass Creek Ranch, Parkman
TENNESSEE	(8) <i>Smith, Rufus, W.</i> Washington St., Fayetteville	CANADA	(8) Alberta— <i>Parton, Ken</i> , 18 Moreuille Wood Dr., Calgary
TEXAS	(9) Northeastern— <i>Fishburn, S. A.</i> , Box 777, Grand Prairie		(8) Atlantic Provinces— <i>MacLeod, Ian</i> , Box 143, Baddeck, Nova Scotia
	(8) Northwestern— <i>Titus, C. B.</i> , 1027 Coble Dr., Borger		(9) British Columbia— <i>Short, William</i> , 3270 West 31st St., Vancouver 8
	(9) Southeastern— <i>Dozier, John</i> , 3737 Nottingham, Houston		(8) Manitoba— <i>Monson, J. Willard</i> , Box 849, Dauphin
	(8) Southwestern— <i>Wilmuth, Dennis</i> , 111 West Harding, Harlingen		(9) Ontario (Eastern)— <i>Moffit, Russell J.</i> , 322 Willard Ave., Toronto
UTAH	(9) <i>Cragun, Cecil</i> , 3439 No., 1000 West, Ogden		(8) Ontario (Western)— <i>Guenther, Lee</i> 158 Herbert St., Waterloo
VERMONT	(8) <i>Supple, John</i> , Mapleleaf Farm, Underhill		(8) Quebec— <i>Hinman, Bess</i> , 3980 Cote des Neiges Rd., Montreal
VIRGINIA	(9) <i>Small, Charles</i> , 442 Fairmont Ave., Winchester		(8) Saskatchewan— <i>Corrigal, Cec</i> , 655 Boulevard Drive, Prince Albert
WASHINGTON	(9) <i>Smith, Al</i> , 3345 59th St. S. W., Seattle 16	PUERTO RICO	(8) <i>Highley, Charles</i> , Box 4809, San Juan
WEST VIRGINIA	(9) <i>Dodd, Cec</i> , Box 844, Weirton	CORRESPONDING MEMBER	Norway— <i>Sonju, Hart</i> , 1117 East Earl St., Philadelphia, Pa.
WISCONSIN	(8) No. Wisc. & Upper Mich.— <i>Borum, Homer</i> , 521 Niagara St., Eau Claire	OVERSEAS OBSERVER	Holland— <i>Adrian Frylink</i> , Box 66, Babylon, L. I., N. Y.

1959 CONFERENCE MEMBERS

(Trustees - Office - Grapevine)

G. S. B. TRUSTEES

NON-ALCOHOLIC

Mr. Frank Gulden
230 Grand Street
New York, N. Y.

Mr. Leonard V. Harrison,
(Chairman)
P. O. Box 223
Old Lyme, Connecticut

Dr. John L. Norris,
(Vice-Chairman)
Medical Department
Eastman Kodak Company
Rochester, New York

Mr. Archibald B. Roosevelt,
(Treasurer)
200 East 66th Street
New York, N. Y.

Mr. Bernard B. Smith
460 Park Avenue
New York, N. Y.

Dr. Harry M. Tiebout
30 Milbank Avenue
Greenwich, Connecticut

Harrison M. Trice,
Ass't. Professor
School of Industrial &
Labor Relations
Cornell University
Ithaca, New York

Mr. L. Ivan Underwood
Vice President
Republic Steel Corp.
Purchase Lane
Rye, New York

ALCOHOLIC

Charlie Brown
3239 West 30th Avenue
Vancouver 8, B. C., Canada

John Park Lee
109 Colonial Avenue
Norristown, Pennsylvania

Cal J. McCarthy, Jr.,
(Secretary)
45 Dearfield Drive
Greenwich, Connecticut

Herbert A. Morse
141 East 44th Street
New York 17, N. Y.

E. D. Sheridan
4569 Lorraine
Dallas, Texas

Alfred Steckman
40-01 Little Neck Parkway
Little Neck, L. I., N. Y.

Richard A. Stevens
2010 Oakmere Drive
Baldwin, L. I., N. Y.

EMERITUS (Non-Alcoholic)

Mr. Frank Amos
136 - 23rd Avenue, S. W.
St. Petersburg, Florida

Mr. A. LeRoy Chipman
Midston House
22 E. 38th Street
New York, N. Y.

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Wilbur A. Smith (Ind. CPA)